

Aatmanirbhar Bharat on the Rise



₹38,400 Crore Record Defence Exports enhancing India's pride

5,500+ Defence Items Delisted from Imports, Boosting indigenous defence industry

12 Saal

Vishwas ke, Vikas ke, Jan-Kalyan ke



Government of Bharat
CBC 22201/13/0016/2627

PM MODI CALLS FOR SECURE MARITIME ROUTES, DAYS AFTER 3 INDIAN MARINERS KILLED IN US STRIKE

A warm G7 reunion

MPOST BUREAU

EVIAN-LES-BAINS (FRANCE): A warm handshake and a pat on the arm marked Prime Minister Narendra Modi and US President Donald Trump's first meeting in 16 months as the two leaders met at the G7 Summit here on Tuesday. The high-profile encounter comes as New Delhi and Washington DC edge closer to a much-anticipated and discussed trade deal after months of differences and friction over imposition of US tariffs on India.

The two leaders held a brief conversation at the gathering of G7 leaders. Inside the summit hall in the French lakeside town of Evian, moments before G7 leaders took their seats around the conference table, PM Modi and President Trump shared a warm exchange that quickly drew attention.

PM Modi walked towards his designated seat as leaders assembled for the session. Trump turned to greet the Prime Minister, extending a



Prime Minister Narendra Modi shakes hands with US President Donald Trump before the plenary session at the G7 summit, on Tuesday, in Evian-les-Bains, France

16 MONTHS LATER

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» PM Modi walked towards his designated seat as leaders assembled for the session. Trump turned to greet the Prime Minister, extending a handshake and exchanging a few words

» As officials bustled around the room making final preparations, the two leaders exchanged a firm handshake and appeared to share a few light-hearted words before the proceedings began.

slated for Wednesday on the sidelines of the gathering.

While details of their brief exchange were not known, the encounter sets the stage for their high-stakes talks.

Following US Secretary of State Marco Rubio's visit to India last month, the two sides are now looking at rebuilding the strained bilateral ties.

The relations witnessed a major downturn after Washington imposed punitive tariffs on India and President Trump made controversial assertions regarding his role in de-escalating the India-Pakistan military clashes last May.

Over the next few months, the US president repeatedly and publicly claimed that he had resolved the military conflict between the two neighbours and saved millions of lives as it was heading toward a full-scale war. Continued on P4

Telegram put on pause for NEET



An Indian Air Force Mi-17 helicopter takes part in a trial run ahead of the NEET-UG re-examination, in Tirunelveli, Tamil Nadu, on Tuesday

Google pulls Telegram; Apple in wait

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Facing the flak for paper leak of the NEET-UG 2026, the government on Tuesday temporarily restricted access to the Telegram messaging app ahead of the NEET-UG 2026 re-examination, with the National Testing Agency (NTA) saying the measure was aimed at tackling cheating rackets and misinformation.

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), acting on recommendations made by the National Testing Agency (NTA), has issued a direction under Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000, restricting access to the Telegram platform in India for a defined and limited period ending June 22, 2026 covering the day of the NEET (UG) 2026 re-examination and its immediate aftermath.

A separate direction requires Telegram to disable in India the message-editing feature for already-posted messages till June 30, addressing the specific structural feature through which the platform has been used to fabricate after-the-event "paper leak" evidence in respect of national

NTA'S TOUGH CALL

» The medical-entrance examination held on May 3 was cancelled amidst allegations of irregularities, leaving lakhs of aspirants in despair

» The re-test is scheduled to be held on June 21

» The NTA said lakhs of people use Telegram for personal, educational, professional and informational purposes and regrets the inconvenience caused to them

» The access restriction is, by its express terms, confined to the period ending 22 June 2026 — i.e. the day after the examination

examinations, the NTA said in a statement. "Both measures have been taken in the interest of public order, in response to the organised use of the platform by cheating rackets to defraud candidates appearing for the NEET (UG) 2026 re-examination scheduled on 21 June 2026," the NTA said. The medical-entrance examination held on May 3 was cancelled amidst allegations of

Continued on P4

IRAN DEMANDS LEBANON PULLOUT

Peace pact hits wall

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI/ EVIA-LES-BAINS (FRANCE): Iran's top diplomat said Tuesday that the tentative deal to end the war with the United States would require Israel to withdraw from Lebanon — a condition Israel has already rejected and that could sink the agreement, leading to the resumption of all-out war.

The deal, which is between the US and Iran, has not been made public, and officials have sometimes offered contradictory interpretations of what is in it.

While Israel is not a party to the agreement, it is part of the war: It joined the US in launching strikes on Iran on Feb. 28, and has since fought the Iran-backed Hezbollah militant group in Lebanon and seized large swaths of that country.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said Israel's continued occupation of southern Lebanon would violate the deal.

"Without the withdrawal of Israeli forces from the territories they occupied during this war, the war has not fully come to an end," Araghchi said.

A US official, who spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss outlines of the agreement, has said the deal did not call for an Israeli withdrawal. And Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said Monday that Israel would remain in Lebanon "as long as necessary."

The negotiations to end the war have been plagued by such disagreements before — leading to a prolonged but uneasy ceasefire that has failed to develop into a permanent end to hostilities, and that has left the Strait of Hormuz, a crucial waterway for the world's energy supplies,



Trump says he'll send agreement aimed at ending war with Iran, opening nuclear negotiations to Congress for review

effectively shut.

Pakistan, a key mediator, has said the deal called for an end to military operations, including in Lebanon, as Iran long insisted. But Araghchi's call for an Israeli withdrawal adds a new wrinkle.

It puts Israel into a dilemma as it juggles trying to degrade Hezbollah's military capabilities and restore deterrence without undermining an agreement championed by its most important ally, the United States.

Israel invaded southern Lebanon after Hezbollah fired missiles across the border during the first week of the war. Since then, it has expanded its military footprint to levels unseen in decades and struck targets deep inside Beirut.

Though Hezbollah has been weakened, it retains the ability to strike Israel, leaving

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B-52 crash kills 8

Bomber crashes moments after takeoff

LOS ANGELES: Eight people aboard a B-52 bomber that crashed shortly after takeoff Monday morning at a US Air Force base in Southern California's Mojave Desert are believed to be dead, according to the Air Force.

"Initial indications are that the crash was not survivable," the Edwards Air Force Base, north of Los Angeles, posted on social media. The cause of the crash is under investigation, officials said.

There was no information yet on the crew, however aerial footage showed virtually nothing left of an aircraft.



Emergency crews responded after the aircraft went down around 11:20 am. Black smoke rose from a large swath of charred desert at Edwards Air Force Base near what appeared to be a runway, with

Continued on P4

FOUND DEAD AT MUSSOORIE HOMESTAY

Mystery shrouds techie's death

MPOST BUREAU

DEHRADUN: A 27-year-old woman working with an information technology firm in Gurugram was found dead under mysterious circumstances at a homestay on the Mussoorie-Dhanolti road, police said on Tuesday.

The deceased was identified as P Radha Gayatri, a resident of Kidwai Nagar East in Delhi. According to police, Gayatri arrived at the Kiana Homestay in Tipridhar late Sunday night with her husband, Soumya Sricharan, who is employed with an IT firm in Pune.

The couple had come to

LAST CHECK-IN

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» On Monday morning, Mussoorie police received information about an unresponsive woman at the homestay

celebrate Sricharan's birthday on Monday, according to police and the deceased's family.

On Monday morning, Mussoorie police received information about an unresponsive woman at the

homestay.

A team from the Mussoorie Kotwali, along with an ambulance, rushed to the spot, and a pharmacist attached to the ambulance service examined the woman and declared her dead.

Continued on P4

SC seeks replies on Aadhaar plea

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday sought response of the Centre and States on a plea alleging misuse of the Unique Identification Authority of India-issued Aadhaar cards as proof of citizenship, domicile and residential address, and seeking directions to restrict its use strictly for identity verification.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice V Mohana issued notices to the Centre and all the states and UTs on a plea filed by advocate Ashwini Kumar Upadhyay and tagged it with the pending similar matters.

The plea has sought directions to the Centre, states and the Election Commission to ensure that Aadhaar is used as a proof of identity and not as a proof of citizenship, domicile, address and date of birth.

The plea, filed through advocate Ashwani Dubey, also sought directions that the use of Aadhaar as a proof of date of birth and residence in the application form for new voter registration be considered against Section 9 of the Aadhaar Act, 2016, Section 23(4) of the RPA, 1950 and Article 14 of the Constitution.

"Section 9 of the Aadhaar Act, 2016 expressly states that 'Aadhaar is not the evidence of citizenship or domicile'. The Unique Identification Authority of India notification dated August 22, 2023 clearly states that 'Aadhaar is proof of identity, not of citizenship, address or date of birth'."

"Despite this, Aadhaar is not only being used as a proof of age, citizenship and domicile for school admission, property purchase and to obtain a birth certificate, ration card, driving licence but also being used in

Continued on P4

ON WELFARE, DEVELOPMENT

States' expenditure rises 131% in 10 years, says CAG report

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: States' aggregate expenditure rose sharply by 131 per cent between 2015-16 and 2024-25, keeping pace with economic growth, as they focused on welfare and development activities, said a CAG report on Tuesday.

Revenue expenditure continued to dominate budgets, averaging over 83 per cent of total spending, while capital expenditure increased in absolute terms but remained a relatively smaller share.

"Social and economic services together accounted for about two-thirds of total expenditure, reflect-



CLOSER LOOK

» 'Social and economic services together accounted for about two-thirds of total expenditure, reflecting states' focus on welfare and development'

THE REPORT WAS RELEASED BY THE COMPTROLLER AND AUDITOR GENERAL OF INDIA (CAG), K SANJAY MURTHY

ing states' focus on welfare and development," said the CAG's Publication on State Finances 2024-25.

The report was released by the Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG), K Sanjay Murthy.

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NEW DELHI: Even as the Trinamool Congress grapples with an unprecedented split, Shiv Sena (UBT), another major player in the Opposition camp, is starting at a crisis, with "six to seven" of its nine Lok Sabha MPs inclined to switch to the ruling Shiv Sena and camping in the national capital, sources said on Tuesday.

It is learnt that Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister and Shiv Sena chief Eknath Shinde was also headed to Delhi late on Tuesday. On its part, Shiv Sena (UBT) has dismissed the possibility of a split in its Lok Sabha ranks, with the party's Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Raut claiming that all its MPs remain united.

Jharkhand: Hotel politics before polls

RANCHI: MLAs of the opposition NDA in Jharkhand were moved to a hotel here, while the INDIA bloc legislators participate in mock polls on Tuesday, two days before the election to two Rajya Sabha seats in Jharkhand.

See P5

Sources said that Shinde was expected to land in Delhi late on Tuesday. "Six to seven MPs are likely to switch sides," a leader of the Shinde camp said.

See P4

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Amid drug quality and patient safety concerns, the Union Health ministry has amended rules to prohibit sale of syrups, including cough syrups, without a doctor's prescription.

The move is aimed at bringing syrup-based formulations, including cough syrups, under stricter regulatory oversight, official sources said.

The amendment has been notified through the Drugs (Fifth Amendment) Rules, 2026, published in the official gazette. The amendment came into force with immediate effect from the date of its publication.

According to the notification issued by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, the word "syrups" has been omitted from item 7 in the "Class of Drugs" column of Schedule K of the Drugs Rules, 1945.

Schedule K specifies categories of drugs that are exempt from certain provisions relating to manufacture, sale and distribution under the Drugs and Cosmetics Act and Rules, subject to prescribed conditions.

The move follows a draft notification issued by the government in December last year seeking objections and suggestions from stakeholders. The ministry said the comments received from the public had been considered before finalising the amendment after consultation with the Drugs Technical Advisory Board (DTAB), the country's highest statutory body on technical

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CRACKDOWN ON ILLEGAL CONSTRUCTIONS RAMPS UP

MCD: ‘217 properties razed & 237 sealed in June so far’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Monday demolished 14 properties and sealed 25 establishments as part of an ongoing citywide crackdown on illegal constructions and violations, while inspections carried out by the Revenue Department crossed 770 in the last 10 days, officials said.

Since the Malviya Nagar hotel fire incident on June 3, the civic body has so far demolished 217 properties and sealed 237 others as part of the enforcement drive, they said.

During the same period, the MCD issued 330 unauthorised construction show-cause notices, 151 sealing show-cause notices and 91 demolition orders.

According to the Revenue



Department's daily inspection report, 29 sites were inspected on Monday, taking the total number of inspections conducted between June 5 and June 15 to 773.

The report said four notices were issued in North district following inspections. A joint

inspection was conducted in New Delhi district, while violations detected in South West district were communicated to the MCD's Najafgarh Zone for further action.

In South East district, an inspected site was found to be an illegal construction and

TAKEAWAYS

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Central and West districts following the day's inspections.

The officials said the civic body also issued 10 show-cause notices for unauthorised constructions and 31 sealing show-cause notices during the day.

According to the MCD's daily action-taken report, demolition action was carried out against 14 properties and 25 properties were sealed on June 15.

The enforcement drive was launched in the wake of a series of tragedies in the city linked to civic infrastructure failures, violations of fire safety norms and corruption.

The officials said the campaign is being carried out across Delhi to curb illegal constructions and ensure compliance with building regulations and safety standards, adding that strict action against violators will continue.

Delhi records 162 dengue, 42 malaria cases this year so far

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi has reported 162 dengue cases, 42 malaria cases and nine chikungunya cases so far this year, according to the Municipal Corporation of Delhi's weekly vector-borne disease report for the week. According to the data, 10 new dengue cases were recorded in a fortnight, bringing the total to 20 by June 15. Meanwhile, three malaria cases and one chikungunya case were recorded during the latest week.

Dengue remained the most prevalent vector-borne disease in the city, though the cumulative tally till June 13 was lower than the 196 cases reported during the corresponding period last year.

Malaria cases also stood at 42, lower than the 70 recorded during the same period in 2025, while chikungunya cases declined from 14 to 9.

Among Delhi's civic zones, the West Zone reported the highest number of dengue cases so far this year at 29, fol-



MCD officials conducted over 8.3 lakh house visits during the week

lowed by the Central Zone with 21 and Civil Lines with 20. For malaria, the West Zone recorded the highest tally at 14 cases. The report also showed that a significant number of cases were either acquired outside Delhi or involved incomplete addresses, making tracing efforts difficult.

As part of anti-mosquito measures, MCD officials conducted over 8.3 lakh house visits during the week to check mosquito breeding and found

4,028 houses positive for mosquito larvae, officials said.

During the week, 3,532 legal notices were issued for mosquito-breeding conditions and 379 prosecutions were launched.

Since January 1, civic authorities have visited more than 1.7 crore households for inspection, issued 34,480 legal notices and launched 3,926 prosecutions as part of vector-control efforts across the city, according to the data.

Police officer persuades man to abandon suicide attempt on flyover

NEW DELHI: A sub-inspector of the Delhi Police's PCR unit prevented a man from taking his own life on the Mahipalpur flyover, an officer said on Tuesday.

Responding to an emergency call, the PCR team rushed to the spot and found the man standing dangerously close to the edge of the flyover.

Sub-Inspector Anil Sharma engaged him in conversation in an effort to calm him down and gain his trust. He also offered him water and continued speaking to him to ease his distress.

During the interaction, Sharma reassured the man while urging him to reconsider his decision, the officer said.

As the conversation continued, PCR staff distracted the man by handing him his mobile phone. Seizing the opportunity, they swiftly pulled him away from the edge and brought him to safety. Police credited the team's quick thinking and prompt action with saving his life.

Delhi Police turns to pvt CCTV network for wider surveillance

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: After integrating CCTV networks managed by civic agencies such as the MCD, NDMC and PWD, Delhi Police has now launched an exercise to map and potentially link lakhs of cameras installed at malls, hospitals, hotels, housing societies, religious places and other private institutions across the city to build a wider surveillance grid, officials said.

According to a communication issued by the joint commissioner of police (technology and project implementation division) dated June 10, all the deputy commissioners of police, along with units handling Railways, Metro and the Indra Gandhi International Airport, have been directed to collect details of sizeable CCTV networks operating within their jurisdictions.

The initiative is part of efforts to create an integrated CCTV network and control room framework across the national capital, enabling law enforcement agencies to access footage from major private and institutional camera



networks during investigations and emergencies.

The exercise focuses on locations where a significant number of CCTV cameras are already connected to a central control room or security room.

These include malls and commercial complexes, hospitals, courts, hotels, bus terminals, religious places, stadiums, conference and exhibition centres, housing societies, RWAs and market associations.

The information being sought is aimed at identifying locations with meaningful CCTV coverage that could assist policing and public safety efforts.

The data will include the number of cameras installed and whether they are con-

nected to a central monitoring facility. However, the communication clarified that the exercise is presently limited to preliminary mapping of CCTV infrastructure and does not amount to immediate integration of camera feeds with Delhi Police systems.

"The purpose at this stage is only preliminary camera mapping. No assurance or commitment regarding integration or sharing of live feed is to be made at this stage," the communication said.

The move is the latest step in Delhi Police's broader plan to create a unified surveillance network across the capital.

Last year, police integrated CCTV systems operated by civic agencies, including the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), New Delhi Municipal Corporation (NDMC), and the Public Works Department (PWD).

Police believe a unified CCTV network would enable quicker access to footage, improve real-time tracking, strengthen crime prevention and support faster investigations across Delhi.

Pak-backed terror network busted, seven apprehended

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police dismantled an alleged Pakistan-backed terror-crime module operating in Delhi-NCR, arresting seven operatives accused of smuggling arms and narcotics from Pakistan and carrying out reconnaissance of potential targets, the photos of which were allegedly shared with handlers across the border, officials said on Tuesday.

The accused were allegedly working for Pakistan-based gangster-turned-terrorist Shahzad Bhatti and his associate Ajmal Gujjar, who investigators believe were operating under the patronage of Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI).

Police said the network was involved in procuring and distributing illegal arms, ammunition and narcotic substances smuggled from Pakistan through drone drops in Punjab and subsequently supplied in Delhi-NCR.

The seven arrested accused have been identified as Anas alias Anas Tyagi (26), Mohit alias Yogi (26),

5 sophisticated semi-automatic pistols, 41 live cartridges, 7 mobile phones seized

Deepak alias Deepak Agrola (38), Arif alias Pradhan (30), Karanveer Singh (26), Jatan (29) and Sabir (30). Several of them have criminal histories involving murder, attempt to murder, dacoity, the Arms Act and the NDPS Act, police said.

Five sophisticated semi-automatic pistols, 41 live cartridges, seven mobile phones containing incriminating chats and voice notes allegedly linked to Bhatti and Gujjar, and a SUV were seized during the operation. Police also recovered details of multiple bank accounts allegedly used for transferring proceeds generated through the sale of narcotics and illegal weapons.

According to police, intelligence inputs received in May indicated that Bhatti and Gujjar were conspiring to carry

out attacks in Delhi-NCR through youths recruited via social media platforms.

Acting on the information, police laid a trap and apprehended Mohit near the Bhagirath Water Treatment Plant in Yamuna Vihar. One illegal pistol, four live cartridges and a mobile phone allegedly containing chats with Gujjar were recovered from him.

His interrogation led investigators to a wider network allegedly engaged in smuggling weapons and narcotics, recruiting operatives and conducting reconnaissance of potential targets.

Police said Anas disclosed during questioning that Bhatti and Gujjar had instructed members of the network to survey various public places and other sensitive locations in Delhi-NCR. Photographs and videos of these sites were allegedly sent to handlers in Pakistan for further planning.

Probe found gang recruited youths online for arms trafficking, narcotics smuggling and reconnaissance activities.

Delhi to notify JJ rehabilitation policy soon

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government will soon notify the Delhi Slum and Jhuggi-Jhopri Rehabilitation and Resettlement Policy, 2026, following a high-level review meeting chaired by Union Home Minister Amit Shah. The meeting was attended by Union Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal, Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the Union Home Secretary, Delhi Chief Secretary and other senior officials from the Centre and the Delhi Government.

During the meeting, Shah directed the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) and the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) to issue tenders within 45 days for rehabilitation projects in five slum clusters under the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model. He also asked officials to expedite preparation of project reports and bidding documents for another 50 clusters.

To accelerate implementation, Shah instructed the Delhi Government to float tenders for at least five PPP-based rehabilitation projects every month.

Emphasising holistic redevelopment, he said rehabilitated settlements should include essential public amenities such as anganwadis, schools, health centres and children's play areas, ensuring improved living conditions alongside housing.

Officials said the policy is expected to benefit nearly four lakh families living in slum clusters across Delhi. Eligibility for rehabilitation and resettlement will be determined on the basis of a cut-off date of January 1, 2025. Shah said the initiative reflects the government's commitment to improving the lives of economically weaker sections through inclusive urban development.

Delhi Police busts mule account supply racket linked to cyber frauds, 10 caught

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Cyber Cell of Delhi Police's East District has arrested 10 alleged cyber fraudsters involved in an organised mule bank account supply racket that facilitated online fraud operations across the country.

The action followed a complaint lodged on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal and an FIR registered under Sections 112(2) and 318(4) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

According to police, the



syndicate procured, operated and supplied bank accounts to cyber criminals for receiving and routing proceeds generated through online scams.

The investigation began after a Kerala resident, Jiji Shyn, reported being duped of Rs 2 lakh, which was allegedly

transferred to a mule account maintained with a private bank. Analysis of the financial trail revealed that the account was part of a larger network supplying bank accounts to cyber fraudsters operating across multiple states.

A dedicated Cyber East team carried out extensive technical and financial investigations, including scrutiny of banking transactions, mobile phone analysis and field verification, leading to the identification and arrest of the accused.

Police said the gang targeted unemployed and finan-

cially vulnerable individuals by luring them with fake job offers and monetary incentives. After opening bank accounts in their names, the accused allegedly took control of ATM cards, cheque books, mobile numbers and internet banking credentials before handing them over to cyber fraudsters.

During the operation, police recovered 11 POS machines, 27 cheque books, 17 ATM cards and 12 mobile phones. Further investigation is underway to identify other associates and beneficiaries linked to the network.

HEAVILY CONGESTED SSN MARG

Delhi government to construct flyover in Chhatarpur area to decongest traffic

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has approved construction of a four kilometres long flyover on SSN Marg in Chhatarpur area with an aim to decongest traffic in south Delhi, PWD minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said on Tuesday.

The Public Works Department (PWD) had last year begun the process for a feasibility study to construct a flyover on the road.

"The stretch is heavily congested due to a mix of slow-moving vehicles and cross

movements during peak and non-peak hours. There are also several farmhouses and religious structures due to which there is heavy footfall. The project has been approved and soon a tender will be floated to hire a company," Singh said.

Surrounded by busy commercial areas and the constant movement of buses, cars, autos, two-wheelers, and pedestrians, this key South Delhi road stretch has turned into a traffic nightmare even during non-peak hours.

"The PWD plans to construct an integrated transit cor-

The Public Works Department (PWD) had last year begun the process for a feasibility study for the flyover

ridor to decongest the entire area. The corridor will include the construction of a flyover, slip roads, and an underpass or foot overbridge to facilitate pedestrian movement," he added.

The heavily congested four-

kilometre stretch of Sant Shri Baba Nagpalji (SSN) Marg between the Anuvrat Marg intersection and DLF farms is mostly used by commuters travelling to Gurugram, Delhi airport, Vasant Kunj and other parts of South Delhi.

Currently, there are three traffic signals along the Anuvrat Marg, approximately 200 metres ahead of the Chhatarpur Mandir intersection.

In June last year, the PWD minister visited the Chhatarpur assembly constituency on the request of area MLA Kartar Singh Tanwar. During the visit,

PWD officials were directed to come up with a plan to decongest the areas.

"The road width varies from 27 to 30 metres, due to encroachments on the road and there are several commercial establishments. So there are a few challenges, which will be cleared after the detailed project report is prepared," an official said.

The road stretch also has several trees for which the consultant will provide details on the number of trees to be felled and the ones that can be saved by transplanting, officials said.

Three held for ₹15L ‘digital arrest’ scam

NEW DELHI: The Cyber Cell of Delhi Police has busted a gang involved in a "digital arrest" scam and arrested three accused, including the alleged mastermind, in connection with a fraud worth Rs 15.31 lakh. The accused have been identified as Ankit (23) from Kannauj, Saif Ansari (24) from Kanpur and Md. Noor Alam (24) from Delhi.

The case came to light after a complaint was lodged on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal. The victim alleged that fraudsters posing as telecom employees, police officers and government officials falsely claimed that a mobile number linked to his Aadhaar was being used for illegal activities.

The victim was kept under continuous video surveillance, threatened with legal action and persuaded to liquidate investments and transfer money to accounts purportedly belonging to RBI auditors. The fraudsters also issued fake RBI receipts to gain his trust.

During the investigation, police traced beneficiary accounts and arrested the accused through technical surveillance and local intelligence. Investigators found that Noor Alam allegedly arranged mule bank accounts and converted the proceeds into USDT cryptocurrency before transferring them to an associate based in Pakistan. Further investigation is underway.

FACILITY COMBINES PUBLIC CONVENIENCE WITH LEARNING AND SKILL DEV

CM opens Citizen Lounge and Learning Centre at DM Office

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a move aimed at redefining citizens' experience at government offices, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday inaugurated a 'Citizen Lounge-cum-New Age Learning Centre' at the New Delhi District Magistrate's Office, transforming a conventional administrative space into a facility that combines public convenience with opportunities for learning and skill development.

The initiative seeks to make government services more citizen-friendly by providing visitors with modern amenities while also creating a resource hub for students and young people, particularly those from economically weaker backgrounds.

During the inauguration, the Chief Minister inspected the air-conditioned Citizen Lounge, library and reading corner, and the newly con-



structed restroom facilities. Calling the project an example of responsive governance, Gupta said citizens visiting administrative offices deserve a dignified and comfortable experience.

"Citizens visiting administrative offices should have a dignified, comfortable and positive experience, and this remains a key priority of the Delhi government," she said.

Emphasising that the initiative goes beyond improv-

ing waiting facilities, Gupta described it as a reflection of a changing approach to governance.

"This facility is not merely a waiting lounge or a library, but a symbol of a new approach to governance and administration. Children from nearby settlements and economically weaker sections will also be able to study here and benefit from facilities that are not ordinarily or easily available to them," she said.

CLOSER LOOK

» 'Citizens visiting administrative offices should have a dignified, comfortable and positive experience, and this remains a key priority of the Delhi government'

» Emphasising that the initiative goes beyond improving waiting facilities, CM Gupta described it as a reflection of a changing approach to governance

development hub, offering books on law, administration, career guidance and competitive examinations. Computers will also be installed to provide access to digital resources. The centre is expected to host career counselling sessions, expert talks, guidance workshops, youth interaction programmes and skill development activities.

Designed to improve public convenience, the Citizen Lounge features comfortable seating, newspapers, magazines and a dedicated reading corner. Senior citizens, women, children and other visitors will be able to wait in a clean and organised environment while accessing government services.

"Our objective is that every person visiting the DM office should leave with better facilities and a positive experience," Gupta said, adding that such initiatives would contribute towards building a more inclusive and citizen-centric capital.

Highlighting the importance of collaboration, the Chief Minister added, "When the three pillars of governance, government, administration and CSR, come together, they create a strong foundation for a city's development and transformation. The Citizen Lounge established at the DM office is a strong example of such coordinated efforts."

The New Age Learning Centre is planned to evolve into a knowledge and skill

Delhi adopts EMI model for 1L smart streetlights

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a first-of-its-kind move for the Delhi government, payments for a major public infrastructure project will now depend on performance rather than upfront expenditure, with the city set to adopt an EMI-based model for the installation and maintenance of nearly one lakh smart streetlights.

PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh Verma on Tuesday said the government would release payments for the project in 60 monthly instalments, making contractors accountable for the functioning of the lighting system throughout the contract period.

"For the first time, we are adopting an EMI model for a project of this scale. Monthly payments will be linked to performance reports. If the lights are functioning properly, payment will be released. This will ensure accountability and proper maintenance," Verma said.

The project, expected to be awarded within the next 10 to 15 days, aims to replace existing streetlights on PWD roads with



smart LED fixtures backed by a seven-year warranty. The minister said strict penalties have also been built into the contract to prevent negligence.

"If a fused streetlight is not replaced within 48 hours, a penalty of Rs.2,000 per day will be imposed. Even repeated faults in the same light will attract penalties," he said.

Beyond the new payment mechanism, the government is also banking on automation to improve service delivery and reduce electricity consumption.

The upcoming streetlights will be connected to a central monitoring system capable of tracking faults in real time and alerting maintenance teams automatically. Authorities will be able to monitor the status of individual lights and ensure prompt action without waiting

for public complaints.

Verma said the brightness level of Delhi's roads would also improve significantly. "At present, many lights operate at around 10 lx. We are upgrading them to 40 lx so roads become brighter and safer," he said.

At the same time, the lights will intelligently regulate their output based on the time of day. "During the early morning hours, close to sunrise, the lights will automatically dim because full brightness is not required then. This will save electricity while maintaining adequate illumination," the minister said.

According to Verma, the combination of smarter technology and energy-efficient lighting could help the government save nearly Rs.300 crore over the next five years.

Verma also said the government is planning to adopt a similar EMI-linked approach for Delhi's CCTV network upgrade. Consultants for Delhi's CCTV upgrade will be finalised soon, with plans to install up to two lakh cameras under an accountability-driven, technology-enabled model.

MCD to start restoration of 8 grade-I heritage structures

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) will begin a phased restoration and preservation exercise of eight Grade-I heritage structures under its jurisdiction, with conservation work expected to commence next month, officials said on Tuesday.

The initiative follows directions from the Supreme Court to restore heritage monuments owned by the civic body and will be undertaken in consultation with academic institutions and conservation experts.

In the first phase, the MCD will take up four tombs in Zamrudpur village, Mahavir Library in Greater Kailash-I, a gumbi in Humayunpur village, a tomb in the LSR village area and Maharaja Agrasen Park on Boulevard Road. The historic Town Hall building in Chandni Chowk and Company Bagh have also been identified, though both are currently maintained by the Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation.

Officials recently held consultations with experts from the School of Planning and Architecture, Jamia Millia Islamia, Indira Gandhi Delhi Technical University for Women and the Aga Khan Foundation to prepare a restoration roadmap. The Aga Khan Foundation has already submitted a memorandum of understanding for participation in the project.

The MCD, which lacks an in-house conservation team, will engage specialised agencies experienced in Archaeological Survey of India projects. Officials said many monuments face challenges from encroachments, overhead utility wires and dense surrounding development.

Rekha Gupta unveils comprehensive GST training initiative to modernise tax admin

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a bid to future-proof Delhi's tax administration amid growing reliance on technology and data-driven enforcement, the city government has made specialised GST training mandatory for its officers, with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday launching a two-week comprehensive training programme for officers and employees of Delhi's Trade and Taxes Department, saying the initiative would help build a more efficient, transparent and technology-driven GST administration focused on better taxpayer services.

At a time when tax administration is increasingly dependent on digital systems and complex legal processes, the Delhi Government has made capacity building a priority by mandating specialised GST training for newly appointed officers. The programme, being held from June 15 to June 26 in

'Tax administration today is no longer limited to revenue collection. It has evolved into an integrated system involving technology, law, investigation, analysis...'

collaboration with the National Academy of Customs, Indirect Taxes and Narcotics (NACIN), aims to equip officials with practical skills in investigation, technology and taxpayer facilitation. Addressing the initiative, Gupta said, "Tax administration today is no longer limited to revenue collection. It has evolved into an integrated system involving technology, law, investigation, analysis and public service. Therefore, regular capacity building and training of officers is essential."

The two-week programme will feature three sessions daily and cover a wide range of GST-related subjects, including taxation principles, supply of goods and services, Input Tax Credit (ITC), registration procedures,

returns, e-way bills, audits, assessments, refunds and tax payments. Officials will also be trained in handling work contracts, job work provisions and input service distributors.

A major focus of the programme will be practical exposure to the GST Network (GSTN). Officers will receive hands-on training in return filing, registration processes, amendments, cancellations, back-office functions, helpdesk operations and grievance redressal mechanisms.

The training will further strengthen enforcement capabilities by covering intelligence gathering, investigations, interrogation techniques, recording statements, inspection and search procedures, arrests,

detention and seizure provisions, along with the use of digital investigation tools.

Officials will also be familiarised with provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNS) and Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA), besides procedures relating to show cause notices, appeals, advance rulings and court matters.

Emphasising active participation, the Chief Minister said, "The programme will provide an important opportunity for officers to familiarise themselves with the latest legal provisions, judicial decisions, technological platforms and departmental best practices."

Gupta said attendance would be mandatory and expressed confidence that the training would make Delhi's GST administration more efficient, transparent and technology-enabled, while improving taxpayer services.

Khan Market redev aimed at global standards: Sandhu



ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Lieutenant Governor of Delhi, Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu, visited Khan Market to review the progress of ongoing redevelopment works and inspect civic improvement initiatives being undertaken by the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC). During the visit, the Lieutenant Governor interacted with local shopkeepers and visitors and directed officials to accelerate the pace of work while maintaining strict quality and safety standards.

Accompanied by NDMC Chairman Keshav Chandra, Vice Chairperson Kuljeet Singh Chahal and senior officials, the Lieutenant Governor reviewed the redevelopment of the middle lane of Khan Market and received a detailed briefing on implementation timelines and project progress.

Highlighting the need to modernise one of Delhi's most iconic commercial hubs, the Lieutenant Governor said efforts were underway to transform Khan Market into an internationally recognised destination aligned with the vision of creating world-class urban infrastructure. He emphasised improvements in civic amenities, traffic management, pedestrian movement and visitor experience while ensuring

290 out of 340 existing and planned rainwater harvesting structures have been completed and made operational

the highest safety standards, including fire safety measures.

During the visit, the Lieutenant Governor also inspected the implementation of Modular Rain Water Harvesting Systems at Satya Marg and stressed the importance of decentralised water conservation infrastructure ahead of the monsoon season. He noted that such systems would strengthen groundwater recharge, reduce localised water logging and support sustainable urban water management.

NDMC Chairman Keshav Chandra informed that 290 out of 340 existing and planned rainwater harvesting structures have been completed and made operational. The remaining projects are expected to be completed by June. Vice Chairperson Kuljeet Singh Chahal said NDMC remains committed to building a cleaner, greener and climate-resilient capital through infrastructure upgrades and sustainable urban development initiatives.

MCD revenue rises 17% to record ₹14,549 cr in 2025-26

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi recorded its highest-ever annual revenue of Rs 14,549.06 crore in 2025-26, a 17.27 per cent increase over the previous financial year, officials said on Tuesday.

The revenue figures were shared by MCD standing committee chairperson Satya Sharma, who said the civic body's total revenue increased from Rs 12,406.75 crore in 2024-25 to Rs 14,549.06 crore in 2025-26, an increase of Rs 2,142.31 crore.

"MCD's own revenue rose from Rs 9,400.20 crore to Rs 11,239.24 crore during the period, registering a growth of 19.56 per cent, while revenue and grants received from the Delhi government increased from Rs 2,983.87 crore to Rs 3,309.82 crore," Sharma said.

The revenue growth comes even as the civic body continues to carry liabilities of more than Rs 15,000 crore, according to a report submitted earlier to Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu.

More than half of the liabilities comprise loans from the Delhi government, followed by internal loans, employee-related dues, including retirement benefits, and pending payments to contractors executing infrastructure projects.

According to an official statement, property tax and property transfer charges remained the corporation's largest sources of income, contributing Rs 3,116 crore and Rs 3,758.59 crore, respectively, in 2025-26.

Revenue from advertisements stood at Rs 441.30 crore, while car parking and leasing of the civic centre's C-Block generated Rs 166.18 crore and Rs 182.71 crore, respectively, the statement read.

Delhi records coolest day of Jun as rain brings respite from heat

NEW DELHI: A spell of rain with strong winds and overcast skies kept Delhi unusually cool on Tuesday, dragging temperatures several notches below normal and providing relief from the sweltering conditions that had gripped the city in recent days, making it the coolest day of June so far.

According to the India Meteorological Department, Palam recorded the highest rainfall of 9.1 mm between 8:30 am and 5:30 pm, followed by Safdarjung at 2.8 mm, Ayanagar at 2.5 mm and Lodhi Road at 1.2 mm, while Ridge recorded a trace.

Maximum temperatures across Delhi-NCR remained below normal. Safdarjung, the city's base station, recorded 33.3 degrees Celsius, 5.5 notches below normal.



Ridge recorded the highest maximum temperature at 34.5 degrees Celsius, 3.8 notches below normal, Lodhi Road at 33.2 degrees Celsius, 5.8 notches below normal, Ayanagar at 32.7 degrees Celsius, 5.9 notches below normal, and Palam at 32.5 degrees Celsius, 6.7 notches below normal.

Minimum temperatures also remained below normal

across the region. Safdarjung recorded a minimum temperature of 25.7 degrees Celsius, 1.8 notches below normal.

Rain triggered by a cyclonic circulation and moisture-laden winds kept temperatures below normal.

Thunderstorms are forecast till June 21, while Delhi's AQI stood at 116 in the moderate category. MPOST

Fire breaks out at factory no one hurt

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A fire broke out at a factory near the Shastri Nagar Metro station at Keshavpuram in north-west Delhi on Tuesday, officials said.

No one sustained any injury in the fire, a Delhi Fire Service (DFS) official said.

The DFS received a call about the blaze at 1 pm and pressed one water tender into service, which took about 50 minutes to douse the flames, he said.

"A cooling operation is underway," the official added.

Satish Upadhyay takes charge as DJB vice-chairman, vows crackdown on corruption

Upadhyay announces governance reforms, improved water services...

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Transparency, accountability and good governance will be the top priorities of the Delhi Jal Board, its newly appointed Vice-Chairman Satish Upadhyay said on Tuesday.

"Strict action will be taken under a zero-tolerance policy against corruption, irregularities and malpractice. DJB is working in mission mode to strengthen water and sewerage infrastructure in the capital," Upadhyay said, according to a statement issued here.

Along with the senior BJP leader, MLAs Manoj Kumar Shukheen, Ajay Kumar Mahawar and Rajesh Kumar Goyal



took charge as members of the Delhi Jal Board (DJB).

Under the Yamuna Rejuvenation Plan, the Delhi government has set a target of enhancing sewage treatment capacity and connecting all unauthorised colonies to the sewer network by December 2028, he said.

He also said the Late Payment Surcharge Waiver Scheme, introduced keeping

The DJB has so far regularised around 3,107 water connections under a special drive

consumer interests in mind, has provided relief to more than 4.6 lakh consumers, with revenue collections of Rs 637.01 crore so far. The scheme is valid till August 15.

The DJB has so far regularised around 3,107 water connections under a special drive, which enables consumers to regularise illegal water connections by paying Rs 1,000, while non-domestic consumers can

do so for Rs 5,000.

To modernise water quality monitoring, the DJB has launched an advanced 24x7 real-time sensor-based pilot project, the Online Water Quality Analyzer, in Gulmohar Park. "If successful, it will be expanded to other areas. This system continuously monitors key water quality parameters such as residual chlorine, turbidity, pH, and total dissolved solids (TDS), enabling engineers to take immediate corrective action in case of fluctuations," the statement said.

Upadhyay also announced that a mega public hearing camp will soon be organised to address issues raised by RWAs and the general public.

CHOUHAN CALLS FOR DISTRICT-LEVEL CONTINGENCY PLANS FOR KHARIF

El Niño to hit 12 states severely

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The impact of El Niño weather phenomenon, linked with a weaker monsoon in India, is likely to be “relatively severe” in 12 states, including Uttar Pradesh and Tamil Nadu, in the Kharif season, according to the agriculture ministry, which on Tuesday directed coordinated action through district-level machinery in the most vulnerable regions.

Other states likely to be impacted by El Niño include Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Karnataka, Odisha, Gujarat, Rajasthan, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand and Maharashtra.

“In 9-10 states where the impact of El Niño may be relatively higher, coordinated meetings should be organised with District Magistrates, Agriculture Departments, Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVKs) and other extension systems of the identified districts,” Agriculture



Workers fill maize grains in sack at a grain market, in Amritsar PTI

minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan, who chaired the weekly review meeting on Kharif 2026 preparations, said.

The minister also stressed the need for advance contingency planning in rain-deficient districts, while also pushing for increased acreage under cotton and pulses, an official statement said.

However, after the meeting, a senior ministry official told news agency that a total of 12 states have been identified that may be severely impacted

due to El Nino this year and contingency plans for 326 districts in these states are being prepared.

El Nino is a climate phenomenon historically linked to weaker monsoons and heightened rainfall uncertainties - a concern that looms large this year.

As per the India Meteorological Department (IMD), El Nino conditions are currently present over the equatorial Pacific Ocean and are expected to strengthen further during

the southwest monsoon season (June-September).

IMD has forecast the southwest monsoon at around 90 per cent of the long-period average, signalling a below-normal season.

Chouhan directed state governments to clearly identify vulnerable districts and prepare crop-wise contingency plans in advance, so that farmers can be promptly provided with options, advice, and assistance in the event of any weather challenge, the minister

Highlights

» States likely to be impacted by El Niño include UP, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Karnataka, Odisha, Gujarat, Rajasthan, Bihar, MP, Jharkhand and Maharashtra

» As per the India Meteorological Department (IMD), El Nino conditions are currently present over the equatorial Pacific Ocean

try said in a statement.

“A separate and practical strategy should be developed for each vulnerable district, with special attention to water conservation, moisture management, intercropping, and alternative crop patterns,” he said.

The minister underscored that the government’s priority is to ensure farmers receive “calm, reliable, and solution-oriented messages based on scientific analysis” rather than alarmist communication.

The meeting reviewed crop-wise targets, sowing progress, and state-wise Kharif 2026 preparations, with particular emphasis on boosting cotton output.

Chouhan called for wider adoption of scientific methods, right variety selection, intercropping, mulching, and moisture conservation to improve both productivity and farm incomes.

The Pulses Self-Sufficiency Mission also figured prominently in the discussions.

ALL 9 LAWMAKERS MARK PRESENCE

Amid ‘Operation Tiger’ buzz, Uddhav holds meeting of party’s LS MPs

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Amid intense speculation that some Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs might switch sides, party chief Uddhav Thackeray on Sunday held a meeting of his faction’s Lok Sabha MPs, which all nine lawmakers attended either virtually or in person.

After the meeting, party’s lone Rajya Sabha member Sanjay Raut said all MPs were loyalists and firmly stood by the party.

Four MPs attended the meeting in person, while four others marked their presence virtually and one Lok Sabha member spoke to Thackeray over phone, he said.

The meeting was held at Thackeray’s ‘Matoshree’ residence in Bandra East area here in the afternoon.

The meeting assumed significance amid the buzz that some MPs might cross over to the ruling Shiv Sena, led by Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde as part of the latter’s ‘Operation Tiger’.



Uddhav Thackeray

In a social media post, Raut said four MPs, including three from Mumbai - Anil Desai, Arvind Sawant and Sanjay Patil - along with Nashik MP Rajabhau Waje, were present for the meeting in person.

Four other MPs - Omprakash Raj Nimbalkar (Dharashiv), Bhausaheb Wakchaure (Shirdi), Nagesh Bapurao Patil Ashtikar (Hingoli) and Sanjay Deshmukh (Yavatmal-Washim) - attended the meeting virtually, he said, adding that MP Sanjay Jadhav (Parbhani) spoke to Thackeray over phone.

Raut said party MLA Aaditya Thackeray was also present for the meeting.

“All MPs are firmly standing united and are loyally

behind the Shiv Sena (UBT). Now at least, we hope the rumour mill will stop!” he said.

An MP, who was part of the meeting, said Nimbalkar attended the meeting online as his son has been admitted to a hospital, while Wakchaure is in Hyderabad attending to his wife who is admitted there.

Jadhav, who had skipped party meetings in the past, was also preoccupied, he said.

Deshmukh cited a similar reason and attended the meeting virtually, as did Ashtikar Patil, who is busy campaigning for his son contesting the legislative council polls, he added.

The MP said party chief Thackeray asked the lawmakers to keep an eye on the disbursement of farm loan waiver money announced by the Maharashtra government and also coordinate with party MLAs wherever possible.

Meanwhile, talking to reporters in Nanded later, Ashtikar said he could not attend the meeting in person but took part in it virtually.

From Page 1

A warm G7

New Delhi stoutly maintained that the cessation of the hostilities was a result of talks between India and Pakistan, and the US involvement had nothing to do with it. Washington’s new immigration policy and its decision to increase the H1B visa fee also contributed to the slide in India-US ties.

However, both sides made efforts in the last few months to repair the ties and even moved forward to firm up a mutually beneficial trade deal soon.

Last week, the relations came under fresh strain after three Indian sailors were killed following the US military’s attacks on three merchant vessels off the coast of Oman.

In their meeting on Wednesday, the two leaders are expected to take stock of the entire gamut of bilateral ties, including the ongoing negotiations for the bilateral trade deal and steps being taken to boost defence cooperation.

The trade pact is expected to be an important step towards a comprehensive bilateral trade agreement, as envisaged during PM Modi’s visit to Washington DC in February last year.

Rubio, during his meeting with the prime minister last month, had invited him on behalf of Trump to visit the White House in the “near future”.

The top American diplomat described India as the “cornerstone” of Washington’s approach towards the Indo-Pacific.

Modi has travelled to France for the G7 summit as India was invited as a guest country to the summit. PM Modi arrived in Evian on a two-day visit to participate in the summit. This marks PM Modi’s seventh consecutive appearance at the G7 Summit, underlining India’s growing role in global discussions.

The Group of 7 brings together seven of the world’s most advanced economies: Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, the United Kingdom and the United States. The European Union is also a member of the bloc.

All countries must ensure that maritime routes remain secure and that seafarers can perform their duties without fear, Prime Minister Narendra Modi told a gathering of G7 leaders including US President Donald Trump, days after three Indian mariners were killed in a US military strike in the Gulf of Oman.

WITH AGENCY REPORTS

Telegram

irregularities, leaving lakhs of aspirants in despair. The re-test is scheduled to be held on June 21.

The NTA said the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C), under the Ministry of Home Affairs, has served as the principal nodal agency coordinating the operational response to the Telegram-based fraud and misinformation targeting NEET candidates.

“This sustained inter-agency effort, well in advance of the present platform-level action, is the reason the harm caused by these rackets has been contained to the extent it has,” it added.

The NTA said over the preceding weeks, channels operating openly on the platform under names that themselves advertised their purpose - “PAPER LEAKED NEET”, “Re-NEET 2026”, “Private Mafia”, “REE NEET MAFIAA” and similar formulations - demanded sums ranging from a few thousand to several lakhs of rupees from candidates and their families, in exchange for purported access to the re-examination paper.

The NTA also cited actions taken by

state law-enforcement agencies. It said the Bihar Police Economic Offences Unit had issued a public advisory on June 9 warning candidates against fraudulent claims of pre-examination access to the paper circulated through Telegram and other platforms.

Acknowledging inconvenience to legitimate users of the platform, the NTA said lakhs of people use Telegram for personal, educational, professional and informational purposes and regrets the inconvenience caused to them.

“The access restriction is, by its express terms, confined to the period ending 22 June 2026 -- i.e. the day after the examination,” it said, adding the message-editing restriction would not affect ordinary use of the platform for sending or receiving new messages.

The agency reiterated that the NEET-UG 2026 re-examination would be conducted as scheduled on June 21.

Meanwhile, Google has removed messaging app Telegram from its Play Store, and Apple is likely to follow suit in compliance with a government order, sources aware of the development said.

The government has ordered Google and Apple to delist the Telegram app from their app stores till June 22 to check paper leaks during the upcoming re-examination of the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET-UG) on June 21.

NTA Director General Abhishek Singh said the restriction on Telegram till June 22 was part of efforts to ensure that the June 21 re-test is conducted without malpractice.

Meanwhile, former BJP state chief K Annamalai said in Chennai that the arrangements for a high-level, classified, military-grade security and AI face recognition for NEET retest on June 21 only add to the already ballooning exam pressure of candidates and would create a new set of problems

Expressing concern over the kind of security to be enforced on the young minds for conducting the NEET retest, Annamalai said “while the government has taken measures to contain leaks, they have forgotten the additional burden they have imposed on a student before they take up an assessment, one that they have spent months preparing for, dissolving the entire purpose of our exam system and the NEP 2020’s goal to reduce “exam stress”.

“Two-tier CRPF+CISF escort with IAF airlift. 4-layer CCTV with AI surveillance. Biometric & facial recognition before entry. Multiple layers of frisking. Multi-level oversight with direct monitoring from the prime minister’s office. Yes, you read it right. But these are not arrangements to buy high-level, classified, military-grade software. These are the arrangements made by the Ministry of Education for the NEET retest scheduled for June 21, 2026,” Annamalai said on X.

Every student would appreciate the government’s efforts to prevent paper leaks by implementing additional security measures and enhanced monitoring. But an increase in scrutiny before entry, extended frisking, and an increase in the overall exam time from 180 minutes to 195 minutes will only add to their already ballooning exam pressure, he said, going critical of the Central government after he announced the launch of his own political outfit recently.

Despite all these arrangements for the examination, there are issues with downloading the admit cards, and NTA has assured students that it will resolve them at the earliest, he said.

B-52 crash

emergency vehicles nearby. The military hasn’t said whether the bomber was armed.

The Boeing B-52 Stratofortress is a

long-range bomber that entered service in 1955. Designed to carry both conventional and nuclear weapons, it has been used in conflicts involving the US military from Vietnam to Iran.

By Monday afternoon, the airfield remained closed and all inbound aircraft were being diverted.

Non-commercial visitor passes for the base were suspended “to allow the installation to focus entirely on emergency response operations,” officials said in a statement.

Edwards Air Force Base is home to a large portion of the US Air Force’s aircraft test and development efforts and is about 161 km north of Los Angeles.

The 412th Test Wing, which runs the base, also conducts developmental testing of all Air Force aircraft, weapons systems, software and components before purchase by the service as well as throughout their lifespan.

The vast desert base is also where Air Force test pilot Chuck Yeager reached a speed of Mach 1.05 and broke the sound barrier in 1947.

The way the B-52 crashed so quickly after takeoff without getting very high or going far makes aviation safety expert Jeff Guzzetti suspect some kind of flight control malfunction. But it’s too soon to say what might have caused the control problem.

It’s possible the controls were rigged wrong after maintenance, he said, or a catastrophic engine problem or a failure of a piece of equipment that was being tested.

“I think it was definitely a controllability issue. Now, whether that was tied to an engine failure, a flight control failure, or some new testing device failure, I’m not sure,” said Guzzetti, who used to investigate crashes for both the Federal Aviation Administration and the National Transportation Safety Board.

Although the Air Force has been flying B-52 bombers for more than 70 years, testing out new equipment on a plane can create new challenges. “A flight test is always riskier than normal operations, so that’s why you have specially trained test pilots, and you should have other safety protocols,” Guzzetti said.

AGENCIES

Mystery shrouds

Initial inquiry revealed that the couple had gone to Rishikesh on June 13, before checking into the homestay at around 11.30 pm on Sunday night.

Sricharan told police that they had consumed alcohol at night and gone to sleep at around 3.30 am. When he woke up, he found his wife unresponsive with blood oozing from her nose and urine discharged from her body, he claimed.

The couple got married on November 8, 2025, and both families originally belong to Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh.

“The body was found lying on the floor without clothes, with bloodstains on the bed sheet. Two empty liquor bottles and food items were found in the room,” police said in a statement.

The deceased’s father, P Sudhakar, has lodged a complaint demanding a probe into the circumstances leading to his daughter’s death.

On Tuesday, a panel of doctors conducted a post-mortem on the body at the Coronation Hospital in Dehradun, which was videographed.

Circle Officer Jagdish Chandra Pant said the preliminary autopsy report revealed no external injury marks on the body.

“To ascertain the exact cause of death, the viscera of the woman has been preserved for further scientific evaluation,” Pant said.

He added that the exact cause of death will be clear only after receiving the detailed post-mortem and viscera examination reports.

CAG report

At the disaggregate level, states’ expenditure remained concentrated in 8 object categories -- including 3 types of grants-in-aid, salaries, pensions, interest payments, subsidies and major works -- accounting for nearly 78.46 per cent of total spending and about 12.38 per cent of combined Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP). This reflects the continued dominance of committed and obligatory expenditures in state budgets, the report said. Total expenditure of the states increased from Rs 22.18 lakh crore in FY 2015-16 to Rs 51.20 lakh crore in 2024-25, an increase of 131 per cent.

“Over the period 2015-16 to 2024-25, despite a substantial increase in total expenditure, the expenditure structure remained largely unchanged, with salaries, pensions, interest payments, subsidies and grants together absorbing a substantial share, indicating fiscal rigidity,” it added. A 10-year trend analysis over 2015-16 to 2024-25 shows that states’ budgetary spending ranged between 15.78 per cent in FY25 and 17.49 per cent in FY17 of the total combined GSDP.

In 2024-25, the sectoral expenditure on the general sector, social sector and economic sector accounted for 29.79 per cent, 39 per cent and 28.68 per cent, respectively, of the total expenditure of Rs 51.20 lakh crore. The composition of expenditure across sectors showed that capital outlay accounted for 5.28 per cent of spending in the general sector, 31.60 per cent in the social sector, and 62.71 per cent in the economic sector.

“This pattern highlights that the economic sector -- covering areas such as infrastructure, industry, and trade -- attracts the bulk of capital investment, while the general sector, which includes administrative and fiscal functions, is predominantly revenue-oriented in nature,” the report said.

States’ Own Tax Revenue (SOTR) is the largest component of revenue receipts, rising significantly in absolute terms and increasing its share from about 49.55 per cent to nearly 50.13 per cent, although its buoyancy weakened in FY 2024-25 over 2023-24.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Aadhaar plea

the application form for new voter registration (Form-6) as a proof of date of birth and proof of residence. And thus, infiltrators and illegal immigrants are obtaining various documents using Aadhaar,” the plea said.

The petition contended that the existing verification mechanism under Form-6 is inadequate and might allow individuals without proper supporting documents to be included in the electoral database.

The plea sought a comprehensive overhaul of the verification framework used in electoral processes and proposed the establishment of a high-powered monitoring committee comprising a retired Supreme Court judge along with cybersecurity and forensic experts to oversee reforms.

No prescription

matters related to drugs.

The decision comes against the backdrop of increased regulatory scrutiny of cough syrups and other liquid oral formulations in recent years following reports of contamination-linked deaths of children in several countries.

According to sources, the latest amendment is expected to enhance traceability and regulatory supervision of syrup-based medicines by ensuring that manufacturers and sellers comply with stricter licensing and quality-control requirements.

Peace pact hits snag

Continued from Page 1
Open questions about the effectiveness of Israel’s campaign.

The extent of Israel’s strikes has at times opened a public fracture between its leaders and US President Donald Trump, who told reporters Tuesday that he was “not happy with the way Israel has handled themselves with Lebanon and with Hezbollah.”

“It just goes on forever,” he said of Israel’s strategy. Israeli strikes in Lebanon have killed nearly 4,000 people, including hundreds of civilians, and displaced more than 1 million. “And when that happens, it throws a negative light on the big deal. And that’s the deal with Iran.”

Trump said he’s open to sending the emerging agreement to the US Congress for review.

Speaking on the sidelines of the Group of Seven summit in the French Alps, Trump said, “I like the idea, send it to Congress, please.” He added, “I mean, who wouldn’t approve it?” The unpublished agreement provides for the “immediate” opening of the Strait of Hormuz and lifting of the blockade, according to a senior US official who spoke to reporters on condition of anonymity to discuss outlines of the agreement on Monday.

It also includes the possibility of releasing Iran’s frozen funds and a USD 300 billion fund to help rebuild Iran if Tehran meets certain benchmarks, senior US officials told reporters Monday. Trump later said

the United States would not “invest” funds in Iran.

Regarding the timeline, regional officials who spoke to AP about the deal said the release of frozen Iranian assets would be tied to Tehran implementing the deal.

Gulf Arab states have also pledged to inject billions of dollars into Iran’s economy, they added, speaking on the condition of anonymity to discuss the negotiations.

Iran’s nuclear program, specifically the fate of its stockpile of highly enriched uranium, would be subject to the 60-day clock. Iran has agreed to discuss ways to possibly “dilute or remove” it, the officials said. However, it remains unclear whether Tehran would agree to that, particularly with hard-liners opposed to giving it up.

French President Emmanuel Macron said France and other Western nations were “ready to take action very quickly” to help reopen the Strait of Hormuz peacefully.

Switzerland’s foreign ministry said a signing ceremony for a deal between the United States and Iran will take place Friday at the Burgenstock resort near the city of Luzern.

Ministry officials said that the location was proposed by Pakistani and Qatari mediators, along with the US and Iran.

The ministry said it has been in close contact with the four countries about the possible signing of the memorandum of understanding that US and Iranian officials announced over the weekend.

Mizoram: 2 BSF jawans sentenced to 42 yrs in jail for gang rape, acid attack

OUR CORRESPONDENT

AIZAWL: A court in Mizoram’s Aizawl district on Tuesday sentenced two Border Security Force (BSF) jawans to 42 years of rigorous imprisonment for raping a woman and attacking her with acid in 2017.

The court, however, acquitted the two of the charge of murdering the rape victim’s friend, whose body was found a few days later.

Additional District and Sessions Judge, Sylvie Zomuanpuui Ralte, had on June 12 convicted the border guards -- Nilanjan Das and Dinesh Kumar -- in the case under various sections of the IPC and pronounced the quantum of punishment on Tuesday.

The court sentenced both convicts to 20 years’ rigorous imprisonment for gang rape, 10 years for rape causing grievous bodily harm and 12 years for acid attack, amounting to a total of 42 years’ rigorous imprisonment, which will run consecutively.

The court also imposed a fine of Rs 60,000 each under these three counts, and on default, they will undergo an additional two months of imprisonment under each count.

Das and Kumar, residents of West Bengal and Uttar Pradesh respectively, raped the woman and attacked her with a corrosive substance near the Gaskata river in Silsuri West village in Mamit district on July 16, 2017.

Police registered a case at Marpara police station two days later based on a complaint filed by the victim’s brother.

The victim and her companion, Rangobi, had gone to the for-

est near the Gaskata stream to collect crabs and wild vegetables when they encountered the accused, who were then posted at a BSF camp in the area along the Mizoram-Bangladesh border.

The survivor testified that the two men forcibly took her to a nearby betel nut plantation, sexually assaulted her and later poured a corrosive substance on her face, causing severe burns, permanent facial disfigurement and loss of vision in one eye.

The court said that Rangbi briefly moved away from the spot when the incident occurred. She was found dead near the crime scene several days after the incident.

Post-mortem and forensic examinations concluded that she had been murdered.

During the investigation, police recovered forensic evidence from the survivor’s clothing as well as from the deceased’s remains.

Laboratory examinations detected traces of a corrosive substance linked to the attack.

The survivor identified the two accused during a Test Identification Parade conducted before a Judicial Magistrate on September 5, 2017, the court said.

During the trial, the prosecution examined 18 witnesses, including medical experts, investigating officers and locals.

The court relied heavily on the survivor’s testimony, which it described as consistent and trustworthy. However, the court acquitted both jawans of the charge of murder in connection with the death of Rangobi, whose body was recovered from a forest area on July 27, 2017.

Ranchi: NDA MLAs being moved to hotel ahead of Rajya Sabha polls

‘We will show how parties are split when our days come’, says Sena (UBT) MP Sanjay Raut

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Legislators of the Opposition NDA in Jharkhand were being moved to a hotel in Ranchi days ahead of polls to two Rajya Sabha seats in Jharkhand, a source in the alliance said.

Leader of Opposition in the state Assembly Babul Marandi said they will hold meetings to chalk out a strategy for the elections on June 18.

Asking if the MLAs would stay at the hotel for two days, he said, “We will hold meetings.” The BJP leader exuded confidence in the victory of the BJP-backed Independent candidate Parimal Nathwani in one of the two Rajya Sabha seats in the state.

A candidate is required to secure a minimum of 28 first-preference votes to emerge victorious. The BJP-led NDA does not have the numbers in the state assembly to make Nathwani a

Highlights

- » Thackeray-led Shiv Sena (UBT) has downplayed the buzz of an ongoing ‘Operation Tiger’ launched by ruling Shiv Sena
- » LoP in Jharkhand Assembly Marandi said they will hold meetings to chalk out a strategy for elections on June 18

winner in the polls, unless there is cross-voting, a ruling party legislator said. In the Jharkhand Assembly, the INDIA Bloc has 56 members, comprising 34 from the JMM, 16 from the Congress, four from the RJD and two from CPI(ML) Liberation.

The NDA has 24 MLAs -- 21 from the BJP and one each from the LJP (Ram Vilas), AJSU Party and the JD(U). The Jharkhand Loktantrik Krantikari Morcha has one MLA.

One of the Rajya Sabha seats in the state fell vacant following the death of JMM co-founder Shibu Soren. The other vacancy is due to the completion of BJP member Deepak Prakash’s ten-

ure on June 21. Meanwhile, amid speculation that some MPs of Shiv Sena (UBT) may engineer a fresh split in the party, party leader Sanjay Raut quipped: We will show how parties are split when our days come.”

Raut, a Rajya Sabha MP, dismissed speculation that some Shiv Sena (UBT) Lok Sabha MPs were contemplating switching over to the ruling BJP-led NDA. “I have no information about it. There is no crisis. If any crisis comes, we will handle it,” he told reporters here at the Parliament House complex. Raut said the party has a 60-year legacy and has a history of waging agitations

for different causes. “We have seen many ups and downs in the past. But ours is a cadre-based party. MLAs and MPs come and go but the party remains,” he said.

On reports of Shiv Sena (UBT) MP Sanjay Deshmukh meeting Union minister Prataprao Jadhav of the rival Shiv Sena, Raut said a “wrong picture was being painted” of the meeting, and asserted that all Parliamentarians remain firmly with the party. Shiv Sena (UBT) Lok Sabha MP Anil Desai also dismissed the suggestion that some of his colleagues may form a separate group.

“There is no such thing. A series of meetings have been conducted by Uddhav Thackrey ji in the last one-and-a-half years and everyone (MPs) attended.

“In the last meeting, four of us were there in person while five of them were on video conferencing. They could not come

to Matoshree in Mumbai because they had their individual engagements, which were fixed much earlier,” Desai said, reiterating that all Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs were together.

The Uddhav Thackeray-led Shiv Sena (UBT) has downplayed the buzz of an ongoing ‘Operation Tiger’ launched by ruling Shiv Sena led by Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde to poach party MPs. Notably, the mascot of the undivided Shiv Sena was a tiger drawn by party founder Bal Thackeray.

Uddhav Thackeray had called a meeting of party MPs. Of the nine Lok Sabha members, only four -- Arvind Sawant, Anil Desai, Rajabhai Waze and Sanjay Patil -- attended the meeting in person, while Omprakash Raje Nimbalkar, Bhausaheb Wakchaure, Nagesh Bapurao Patil Ashtikar and Sanjay Deshmukh attended online. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

AHEAD OF KOTA STUDENT CONVENTION ‘Concepts of responsibility, integrity alien to govt’: Rahul

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A day before his student convention in Kota, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday alleged that the Modi government is shattering crores of dreams everyday using the tools of paper leaks, exam mismanagement, cancelled recruitments, skyrocketing fees, and privatisation.

Gandhi said securing the future of every young Indian is the Centre’s responsibility but both responsibility and integrity are concepts “alien” to the government.

“My young and Gen Z friends, one thing is clear to me, and I want you to engrain this in your heart as well: securing the future of every young Indian is the government’s responsibility. Yet, both responsibility and integrity are concepts alien to the Modi government,” the leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha said in a post in Hindi on X.

“Paper leaks, exam mismanagement, cancelled recruit-

Takeaways

- » Gandhi said securing the future of every young Indian is the Centre’s responsibility
- » Remember, the future of

the youth will determine the future of the nation, Gandhi said

- » The June 17 event is the first in a series of student conventions that Gandhi will address across the country

ments, skyrocketing fees, privatisation, and scams—these are the very tools with which they are shattering crores of dreams everyday. Remember, the future of the youth will determine the future of the nation,” Gandhi said adding that he wants to discuss all of this with students in detail.

“That is why I am calling upon you—let us transform the ‘voice of students’ rising from every street, town, and city across the country into a powerful roar in Kota,” he said.

The Congress has projected the Kota programme as part of its outreach to students and youth affected by alleged paper leaks and examination-related irregularities.

The June 17 event is the first in a series of student conventions that Gandhi will address across the country. The Congress has set a target of bringing nearly 10,000 students to the event.

It said the campaign seeks to highlight the challenges faced by young people due to alleged paper leaks, rising examination costs and what it described as the government’s failure to ensure a fair and transparent recruitment and education system.

Kota in Rajasthan is a prominent coaching hub in the country where nearly 1.2 lakh students are preparing for NEET and JEE in various coaching institutes.

CJP won’t contest polls, indicates Dipke

Holds protest in Nagpur, faces counter-protest by ‘saffron’ activists

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NAGPUR: Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke on Tuesday indicated that his party was not keen on contesting elections, and also criticised Prime Minister Narendra Modi for ‘not reaching out’ to the country’s students following the NEET-UG fiasco.

Dipke held a press conference here ahead of the CJP’s protest in the city to seek Union Education minister Dharmendra Pradhan’s resignation.

Asked whether the CJP will contest elections, Dipke said, “Why should we contest elections? I mean, if everyone in this country has to contest elections to demand their rights... how will it work?”



CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke during a press conference, in Nagpur PTI

To a question about whether the prime minister should address the country’s youth and assure them that paper leaks will not happen again, Dipke said Modi should first apologise to the parents of the five or six students who committed suicide (in the aftermath of the cancellation of the NEET-UG scheduled for May 3).

“Pradhan Mantri ji tweets

if anything happens across the world, but here students of this country are committing suicide and there is not even a condolence tweet for them from the prime minister. How long will you talk about your ‘Mann ki Baat’ and ‘Pariksha pe Char-cha’? At least listen to students’ Mann ki Baat,” said Dipke.

Meanwhile, wearing cockroach masks, displaying placards and raising slogans for justice, hundreds of youths, students and people from different walks of life participated in a protest organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) in Nagpur.

Speaking on the occasion, Dipke advised youths to stay away from religion-based politics.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHANDIGARH: A day after the Sikh clergy declared him ‘Guru Dokhi’ (anti-Guru) and ‘Khalsa Panth virodhi’ (anti-Khalsa Panth) over an “objectionable” video, Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Tuesday rejected it, saying the person in the video was not him.

In a video message, the chief minister expressed surprise over the people occupying the highest positions of religious bodies “indulging in false propaganda at the behest of their political bosses” to defame him.

In a post on X, Mann said, “The president of the Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee has openly become



Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann addresses a press conference, in Chandigarh, Tuesday PTI

a propagandist for the Akali Dal.

“The only thing left now is to get a directive issued through the Jathedar Sahib saying, ‘Vote for Sukhbir Badal, otherwise the ‘Panth’ is in danger.’ Such a decision could be taken at any time,”

he said.

The matter stems from the summoning of Mann by the Akal Takht, the highest temporal seat of Sikhs, in January this year for allegedly making comments on ‘Guru ki Golak’ (gurdwara donation box) and indulging in “objectionable activities” with the pictures of the Sikh Gurus and slain militant Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale in a purported video clip.

In his video message on Tuesday, Mann said a ‘hukamnama’ (edict) had been issued against him over the video, claiming that it featured him and that it was not AI-generated.

“I completely reject this video,” he said.

Mann said when he was summoned to the Akal Takht

earlier, he had said that it was not him in the purported video.

“The person seen in the video does not match my height and physique,” he said.

“But I am surprised at how the people sitting at the highest positions of religious bodies are indulging in such false propaganda at the behest of their political bosses,” Mann said, alluding to Akal Takht Jathedar Giani Kuldeep Singh Gargaj, who pronounced the edict against the CM on Monday.

The BJP on Tuesday said that the Akal Takht declaring Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann ‘anti-Guru’ and ‘anti-Khalsa Panth’ over an “objectionable” video will have far-reaching political and social consequences.

States agree to Kishau Dam project



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Agreement emerged after years of delay on the Kishau Multipurpose Dam Project, following talks led by Union Home minister Amit Shah at a top-tier gathering in the capital city midweek. Despite complex disagreements in prior rounds, representatives from each involved state aligned their positions during the session.

This deal represents progress on a long-delayed initiative. With consensus now reached, execution can begin after years of stagnation.

Progress emerged following sustained discussions between involved parties. Resolution came not through pressure, but by structured coordination across groups.

Leadership at the Centre described the outcome as consistent with current methods in governance.

Instead of confrontation, emphasis was placed on alignment and shared understanding. Such advancement illustrates how persistence in talks yields results over time.

National challenges, when approached collectively, show signs of movement. Past delays did not prevent eventual agreement under this administration. Dialogue remains central whenever difficult decisions require resolution.

Tgana: 735 docs fall prey to cyber frauds, lose nearly Rs 30 cr

OUR CORRESPONDENT

HYDERABAD: As many as 735 doctors in Telangana have lost nearly Rs 30 crore to cyber frauds since September 2024, a senior police official said on Tuesday.

Addressing a high-level interaction meeting with the medical fraternity on cyber awareness here, Telangana Cyber Security Bureau (TGCSB) Director Shikha Goel highlighted the rapidly evolving cyber threat landscape and emphasised the need for greater vigilance among healthcare professionals, an official release said.

PM must take up with Trump killing of Indian seafarers, says Priyanka

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi Vadra on Tuesday urged Prime Minister Narendra Modi to take up with US President Donald Trump the issue of the killing of three Indian seafarers in American attacks on ships when the two leaders meet on the sidelines of the G7 Summit in France.

Prime Minister Modi and Trump are set to meet on the sidelines of the G-7 meeting in France on Wednesday. This will be the first meeting between the two leaders since February last year in Washington and comes against the backdrop of concerns over the death of Indian mariners on



Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra speaks to the media, in New Delhi, Tuesday PTI

commercial ships targeted by the US navy in the Strait of Hormuz.

Speaking with reporters, the Congress leader said, “Yes, I think definitely he should take it (the issue of three Indian sailors killed in US strikes) up.”

“It is surprising that we are not more outspoken about

what is happening,” the Congress general secretary said.

The meeting between Trump and Modi will also be the first face-to-face interaction since the India-US relationship hit a rough patch after Operation Sindoor and Washington’s decision to impose heavy tariffs on New Delhi.

The two leaders have had a couple of phone calls and also agreed on a framework for an interim bilateral trade deal in February, which is being negotiated.

Priyanka Gandhi’s remarks come after the US said it conveyed to India that any violation of its blockade in the Strait of Hormuz and illicit transport of Iranian oil will not be tolerated.

Parties collected Rs 281 crore, spent Rs 193 crore during Bihar polls: ADR

Publicity emerged as the single largest expenditure head

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI, Jun 16 (PTI) Political parties contesting the 2025 Bihar Assembly elections collected funds worth Rs 281.32 crore and spent Rs 193.47 crore during the poll period, with publicity accounting for the largest share of expenditure, according to a report by the Association for Democratic Reforms.

The report analysed expenditure statements filed by five national parties -- BJP, Congress, AAP, BSP and CPI(M) -- and five regional parties -- RJD, JD(U), LJP (Ram Vilas), AIMIM and CPI.

According to the report, the 10 parties together collected Rs 281.323 crore while their total expenditure stood at Rs 193.466 crore, leaving a gap of nearly Rs 88 crore between funds raised and expenditure declared.

Publicity emerged as

Key Points

- » Publicity emerged as the single largest expenditure head, accounting for Rs 100.429 crore or 36.68 per cent of the total spending
- » The report analysed expenditure statements filed by five national

parties -- BJP, Congress, AAP, BSP and CPI(M) -- and five regional parties -- RJD, JD(U), LJP (Ram Vilas), AIMIM and CPI

- » The ADR report noted that travel expenses constituted 29.05 per cent of the total expenditure declared under various heads

the single largest expenditure head, accounting for Rs 100.429 crore or 36.68 per cent of the total spending. Parties also spent Rs 79.539 crore on travel expenses and Rs 62.072 crore as lump-sum payments to candidates.

Expenditure on virtual campaigning through social media platforms and other digital means stood at Rs 13.074 crore, while parties spent Rs 3.886 crore on publishing the criminal antecedents of candidates, as

mandated by the Election Commission. Miscellaneous expenses amounted to Rs 14.804 crore.

The Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) report noted that travel expenses constituted 29.05 per cent of the total expenditure declared under various heads, making it the second-largest component of election spending after publicity.

A total of 161 political parties, including six national parties, 10 regional parties and 145 registered unrecognised

political parties (RUPPs), contested the Bihar Assembly elections. However, the analysis was confined to 10 major parties whose expenditure statements were available.

The BSP was the only party among those analysed that did not declare any funds collected either at its central headquarters or state-unit level during the Bihar Assembly election period, the report said.

ADR said political parties are required to submit statements detailing funds collected and expenditure incurred by their central headquarters and state units during the election period to the Election Commission within the prescribed time limit after the completion of elections.

The report was based on expenditure statements submitted by political parties to the Election Commission following the Bihar Assembly elections held in 2025.

कार्यालय नगर परिषद जौरा, जिला मुरैना (म.प्र.)

क्रमांक/निर्माण/2026/1641

जौरा, दिनांक 11/06/2026

ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

निम्नलिखित कार्यो हेतु केन्द्रीकृत प्रणाली के अन्तर्गत लोक निर्माण विभाग में पंजीकृत समस्त ठेकेदारों से अधोलिखित कार्य हेतु ऑनलाइन निविदाये आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा का विस्तृत विवरण www.mptenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

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नोट :- निविदा से संबंधित किसी भी प्रकार के संसोधन का प्रकाषन ऑनलाईन www.mptenders.gov.in की वेबसाइट पर ही किया जावेगा, पृथक से समाचार पत्र में प्रकाषन नहीं किया जावेगा। अन्य किसी भी प्रकार की जानकारी हेतु ही स्टोर निर्माण में कार्यालयीन समय में सम्पर्क करें। समस्त विवादो के लिये न्याय क्षेत्र जौरा होगा

अध्यक्ष

नगर परिषद जौरा, जिला मुरैना

मुख्य नगरपालिका अधिकारी

नगर पालिका परिषद जौरा, जिला मुरैना

IIT-K DIRECTOR DEFENDS MOVE

Telegram ban ahead of re-NEET sparks debate

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Centre's decision to temporarily restrict access to the Telegram messaging platform ahead of the NEET-UG 2026 re-examination has sparked a sharp debate on social media, with critics questioning the effectiveness of the measure and supporters arguing it is necessary to prevent the spread of misinformation and fake paper-leak claims.

The restrictions, imposed until June 22, come just days before the re-examination and are part of the government's efforts to ensure a fair and malpractice-free conduct of the medical entrance test. In addition, Telegram has been directed to disable its message-editing feature for already-posted messages until June 30.

The move has drawn criticism from several students and technology experts. Among them is Nisarga Adhikary, a self-described ethical hacker who had earlier highlighted alleged security vulnerabilities in the CBSE's on-screen marking (OSM) system.

Reacting to a post by the National Testing Agency (NTA) on X, Adhikary argued that restricting Telegram would not effectively stop paper leaks, as users could easily bypass such measures through proxies and other circumvention tools.

"Can't stop paper leaks, ends up blocking Telegram. Blocking Telegram totally isn't even possible," he wrote, adding that the platform's architecture allows users to find alternative ways to access it.

Defending the government's decision, IIT Kanpur Director Manindra Agrawal said the primary concern was not merely the circulation of leaked examination papers



HIGHLIGHTS

» The restrictions, imposed until June 22, come just days before the re-examination

» It is part of the government's efforts to ensure a fair and malpractice-free conduct of the medical entrance test

but the spread of fabricated leak claims that appear genuine and create panic among candidates.

According to Agrawal, a similar situation had occurred during the JEE Advanced examination, where false claims regarding paper leaks were circulated online, causing confusion among students.

"The problem with Telegram channels is not sharing leaked papers alone. There are many ways to do that. The concern is that fake leak claims can be made to appear authentic, creating unnecessary confusion among candidates," he wrote on X.

Another critic of the restrictions, 18-year-old student activist Sarthak Siddhant, questioned the rationale behind singling out Telegram. Siddhant had previously gained attention during the controversy surrounding CBSE's OSM system and had raised concerns over the tendering process for

selecting a vendor for the Class 12 evaluation exercise.

In a series of posts, Siddhant argued that misinformation exists across multiple communication platforms and asked why Telegram alone was being targeted. He questioned whether other platforms, including WhatsApp and X, should also face similar restrictions if misinformation was the underlying concern.

Responding to these arguments, Agrawal pointed to what he described as a unique feature of Telegram. Unlike many other social media platforms, he claimed, Telegram allows users to edit previously posted messages without clearly indicating that changes have been made. Such a feature, he argued, could enable individuals to create fake leak narratives after the fact without leaving visible evidence of edits.

"One can still argue that banning is not a good idea. But the context of the ban needs to be understood," Agrawal said.

NTA Director General Abhishek Singh defended the restrictions, saying they were part of a broader strategy to eliminate malpractice and maintain the integrity of the examination process.

"We will not let anything go wrong. We will take all possible actions to ensure that the examination is conducted without any malpractice," Singh said.

NCR to get 4 new greenfield cities

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The National Capital Region (NCR) is poised for a major urban expansion with plans to develop four new greenfield cities — one each in Delhi, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan — under a regional growth strategy approved by the National Capital Region Planning Board (NCRPB).

The proposed initiative is expected to involve an investment of around Rs 5,000 crore over the next five years. The plan was discussed at a meeting of the NCRPB chaired by Union Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal. The meeting was attended by Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini, Uttar Pradesh Urban Development Minister A.K. Sharma and Rajasthan Urban Development Minister Jhabar Singh Kharra,



Union minister Manohar Lal chairs a meeting of the NCRPB

MPOST

among other senior officials.

According to officials, the proposed urban centres are aimed at promoting balanced regional development, easing population pressure on existing cities and creating new growth hubs across the NCR.

Speaking after the meeting, Manohar Lal said the selection of the new urban centres would be carried out through a competitive process. Each participating state will propose three potential loca-

urban growth. He added that the upcoming urban centres could be branded as "Namo Cities", in line with the Namo Bharat rapid rail network operating across the NCR.

The NCRPB also reviewed progress on the Regional Plan-2041, which outlines the long-term vision for the region's development. Discussions focused on urban growth patterns, infrastructure requirements and environmental sustainability. Manohar Lal said several issues raised earlier had been resolved and the plan is now expected to be formally notified soon.

Another key proposal discussed at the meeting was the restructuring of the NCR into three distinct zones, including a core central region. The move is intended to strengthen environmental governance and improve the implementation of pollution-control measures across the region.

THREE COMPLAINTS FILED

Ram Temple donation theft probe intensifies

AYODHYA: Three separate complaints were submitted to the police on Tuesday regarding the alleged theft of donation money from the Ram Temple, while the Special Investigation Team (SIT) continued its probe into the case. No FIR had been registered till Tuesday evening.

The complaints were filed by Dharm Sena founder Santosh Dubey, Uttar Pradesh Youth Congress vice-president Sharad Shukla and the Karni Sena. The SIT reached the Ram Temple around 11 am and continued questioning employees suspected of involvement in the alleged theft. Ayodhya District Magistrate Shashank Tripathi and Senior Superintendent of Police Gaurav Grover also visited the temple along with the

investigation team.

On Monday, the SIT questioned Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust General Secretary Champat Rai and later summoned trust member Gopal Rao. The team also interrogated 42 employees associated with counting donations.

According to sources, investigators examined possible security lapses, including the absence of checks on employees while leaving the temple premises. Five names — Lav Kush, Avnish, Anukalp, Karune and Ram Shankar — have surfaced during the probe. Based on their disclosures, police have recovered around Rs 2 crore so far. Lav Kush and Anukalp are currently in custody.

MPOST

Census Phase 1 completed in 23 states, UTs

NEW DELHI: Phase one of the 2027 Census -- house listing and housing census (HLO) -- has been completed in 23 states and Union territories so far, a government statement said Tuesday.

A 15-day self-enumeration process is underway in Kerala and Nagaland, followed by a field operation starting on July 1 and continuing until July 30, it said.

The field operations for the phase commenced in Himachal Pradesh on Tuesday, and are already underway in Gujarat, Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, Puducherry and Uttar Pradesh.

"Residents who have completed self-enumeration are requested to keep their generated self-enumeration ID ready and share the same with the enumerator during the field visit to complete the HLO process. Households that have not opted for self-enumeration will be covered during the physical house-to-house visit by enumerators,"



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

the statement said.

The Rs 11,718 crore census exercise, which is the eighth since Independence, is being conducted in two phases -- the first stage is known as house listing and housing census, while the second stage is the population census.

The housing listing and housing census, which started on April 1 and will continue till September 30, will systematically list all structures, houses, and households throughout the country to provide a sound framework for the population enumeration.

The Rs 11,718 crore census exercise, which is the eighth since Independence, is being conducted in two phases

In a first, the exercise will be digital, with enumerators using a special mobile application to collect the information.

During the housing listing field operations, enumerators will physically visit each house and building and ask citizens 33 questions about basic facilities in their homes, information about the head of the household, such as name and sex, and ownership status, among others.

For the first time, citizens have also been provided a self-enumeration platform on a specially developed website where

they can answer the notified questions, generate an ID and provide it to the field enumerator when they come for verification, saving valuable time.

Every state will have to provide a 15-day window for self-enumeration immediately preceding the month-long field operations during which enumerators will go door-to-door with their questionnaire to collect data.

The state and UTs can choose a period -- 15 days of self-enumeration followed by 30 days of field exercise -- between April 1 and September 30 to complete the HLO phase.

The second phase of the census -- population enumeration -- will be conducted in February next year, in which demographic, social, and economic particulars of every person in the country will be recorded. Caste-related questions will also be part of the second phase.

MPOST

Amritsar: NIA attaches property of LeT operative

NEW DELHI: The National Investigation Agency (NIA) on Tuesday attached a house in Amritsar allegedly linked to a Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) operative in a transnational narco-terror network case with links spread across several countries.

The property, identified as House No. 33, Holy City, Holy Enclave Phase-I, Amritsar, has been attached as "proceeds of terrorism," the agency said in a statement.

An NIA team carried out the attachment after following due legal procedures, in the presence of independent witnesses and with the assistance of local authorities.

According to the agency, the property is registered in the name of the father of accused Ankush Kapoor, described as a key India-based operative of the narco-terror network spread across Italy, Australia, Iran, Thailand, the UAE and Pakistan, among other countries. The NIA said its investigations had revealed Kapoor's links with a Dubai-based accused connected to the Pakistan-based banned terrorist organisation LeT. Kapoor, who was arrested last year, was found to be an important operative in a conspiracy involving the smuggling, transportation, storage and distribution of narcotic substances. He is also accused of laundering proceeds of terrorism to accused persons in various countries.

Investigations further revealed that proceeds generated through narcotics trafficking were being used to finance and support terrorist activities in India through a complex financial network, the agency said. The NIA had earlier charge-sheeted Kapoor for his alleged role in terror-funding activities, criminal conspiracy and providing support to unlawful and terrorist networks. He was also booked for offences under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act and the Indian Penal Code (IPC).

A total of 26 accused have so far been charge-sheeted in the case.

MPOST

B'desh PM's aide: Returned from Delhi airport in 'instant protest'

DHAKA: A top adviser of the Bangladesh Prime Minister on Tuesday said he returned home from New Delhi airport after he was initially denied entry as he felt the need for an "instant protest".

Zahed Ur Rahman, the PM's Adviser on Policy and Strategy Affairs, and Information and Broadcasting, was stopped at the Indira Gandhi International Airport in New Delhi on Sunday when his name was reportedly flagged during a routine security check, state-run BSS news agency reported.

Although Indian authorities later allowed him to proceed with his visit, he decided to return home, it added.

"I felt there needed to be an instant protest," Rahman told a press conference here, speak-

He was stopped at the airport after his name reportedly flagged during a security check

ing for the first time about the incident.

He alleged that despite being informed by the Bangladesh officials about his official tour in advance, he was made to wait for around two and a half hours upon arrival at Delhi airport and was initially denied entry. "I felt a message needed to go out, both inside and outside the country, that this is not (deposed premier) Sheikh Hasina's government; this (BNP regime) is a government elected by the people,"

he said.

He added that Indian authorities eventually tried to facilitate his entry following instructions from higher authorities, but he preferred to return home as a mark of protest. He returned to Dhaka via Colombo.

Bangladesh on Monday summoned India's Deputy High Commissioner Pawan Badhe and conveyed its "deep disappointment" over the incident. Rahman said he did not intend the incident to create any "tit-for-tat escalation". The cooperation should be based on equality, including trade and other areas, he added.

The adviser was travelling on a regular Bangladeshi passport with a SAARC visa and was not carrying a diplomatic passport.

AGENCIES

Bundelkhand: 3 generations still waiting for water

Family walks six kilometres to the 'only functioning' borewell in the block

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

KEY POINTS

» Banda has recorded the highest temperatures in the country this summer, with weeks of over 45 degrees Celsius

» In 2023, the Jal Mission came with a camera and a ribbon. They cut the ribbon. The taps



flowed for three days. Then they went dry. The pipeline was laid. The pump never arrived. The contractor vanished'

said. "By the time the sun comes up, it is already too hot to walk." Banda has recorded the highest temperatures in the country this summer, with weeks of over 45 degrees Celsius.

She carries three earthen pitchers — different sizes. The largest on her head, the second balancing on top, the third in the crook of her left arm. The weight presses into her spine. It feels like a sahukar's debt that never ends. In 2023, the Jal Mission came with a camera and a ribbon. The taps flowed for three days. Then they went dry. The pipeline was laid. The pump never arrived. The contractor vanished.

Rajkumari's husband migrated to Lucknow three

years ago. He works as a construction labourer and sends Rs 8,000 a month — not enough for the family. Her daughter skips school twice a week to help fetch water.

"There is a saying in our village," Rajkumari said. "May your husband die, but the pitcher should not break?" At 17, Nisha is the first in her family to finish high school. She wants to study nursing. She wants to leave. "I have carried water for ten years," she said, looking at her cracked palms. "I have carried it longer than I have carried a pen."

She knows that 62 lakh people have migrated from Bundelkhand since 2005 due to drought. But she doesn't know

what she will do when her board exams come.

Three generations. One struggle. For Sukhrani, water was lost to drought. For Rajkumari, it disappeared behind broken promises. For Nisha, it is taking her education.

The Har Ghar Jal scheme promised piped water to 2.67 crore rural households. Official data claims over 90% coverage in Bundelkhand. The reality is different. Raja Bhaiya of Vidya Dham Samiti works in Banda and Patha. "Plastic pipes can be seen jutting out of the ground, but water has not trickled from them," he told this reporter. At Nibi village, pipelines were laid for 94 households. None get water. Phulla, a villager, said: "A year has passed. We lodged complaints. The work remains incomplete."

A government audit revealed that Uttar Pradesh accounts for 84% of all complaints filed against the Jal Jeevan Mission — 14,264 out of 17,036 nationally. Poor construction, financial irregularities, and village committees that exist only on paper were among the findings. The audit targeted 171 officials and 120 contrac-

tors. Inquiries were opened.

Sukhrani does not know about audits or budgets. She knows what no water means.

In mid-March, Nisha did not return from the borewell. Rajkumari found her daughter sitting on the ground, face buried in her hands. "The school called," Nisha whispered. "They said if I miss one more day, I cannot sit for the board exams."

That evening, Sukhrani picked up her walking stick. "I will go tomorrow," she said. Rajkumari shook her head. "Ammma, you cannot walk," Sukhrani replied: "I walked before you were born. I will walk after you are gone. The water does not care who carries it. But the girl must study."

The next morning, Sukhrani left at 4 am — not waiting, but leaving. Inside, Nisha lay awake, listening to her grandmother's footsteps fade into the dark. She whispered: "Ram ji, exam pass karwa do."

This is not a story of triumph. It is the story of three women who refused to wait any longer. They are still walking. But one of them is walking towards an examination hall instead of a borewell.

Rajouri: Four soldiers hurt in accidental landmine blast

RAJOURI/JAMMU: Four Army personnel, including a junior commissioned officer, were injured in an explosion near the Line of Control in Rajouri district of Jammu and Kashmir on Tuesday, officials said.

The blast was caused by accidental activation of a landmine during area domination patrol by Army personnel in forward Kalal area of Nowshera sector, the officials said.

A JCO and three soldiers were injured in the blast and were immediately evacuated to hospital for treatment, the officials said.

As part of the anti-infiltration drive, the forward areas are dotted with landmines, which sometimes get washed away by rains, resulting in such accidents, they added.

MPOST

Mann: Punjab to frame policy for unauthorised colony plot buyers

CM Mann said thousands of innocent buyers had suffered due to the actions of colonisers

basic amenities such as electricity, water supply and sewerage connections.

Drawing a distinction between genuine buyers and developers, the Chief Minister alleged that fraudulent colonisers lured people through attractive brochures and false promises. He said these developers sold plots, earned profits and abandoned the projects, concealing the fact that essential services and approvals could not be secured for the colonies. Reiterating his gov-

ernment's commitment to protecting genuine buyers, Mann said innocent citizens who invested their savings due to lack of awareness would be safeguarded, while strict legal action would be taken against rogue colonisers.

He said the relief package and policy being prepared would be implemented uniformly across Punjab and not restricted to a few cities, ensuring that all affected residents receive justice.

He also announced that a meeting with senior officials would soon be held to examine suggestions received from residents and review pending legal and financial issues linked to unauthorised colonies. The government, he said, would work towards a practical and long-term solution.

MPOST

Nation Briefs

PUNJAB CM HANDS APPOINTMENT LETTERS TO 523 HEALTH DEPT RECRUITS

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann on Tuesday handed over appointment letters to 523 youths recruited in the Health Department and said his government has ended the practice of securing government jobs through money and political influence. Addressing the newly recruited candidates, Mann said the AAP government has provided 67,563 government jobs in the past four years through a transparent and merit-based recruitment process. He claimed the initiative has restored public confidence in government hiring and helped reverse the trend of young people leaving Punjab in search of employment.

COURT ALLOWS NEET PAPER LEAK ACCUSED TO APPEAR FOR RE-TEST ON JUNE 21

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Tuesday allowed an accused in the NEET-UG paper leak case to appear for the re-examination scheduled for June 21 while in custody. Vacation Judge Vishal Gagne was hearing the interim bail plea of the accused, Yash Yadav, to appear for the re-exam after the NTA on May 3 cancelled the NEET-UG, held on May 3 for medical admissions amid allegations of paper leak. He said while the applicant faced grave allegations of wrongful dissemination and trading in the confidential questions of the very examination in which he now seeks to appear, his rights as a student cannot be defeated by turning bail into punishment by denying him the opportunity to appear for the re-examination.



EDITORIAL
SMALL NATIONS, BIG DREAMS

The FIFA World Cup has always been a tournament of giants. Brazil, Germany, Argentina, Italy, France and Spain have traditionally dominated the narrative, while smaller footballing nations often arrived merely hoping to avoid humiliation. Yet, as the 2026 FIFA World Cup unfolds across North America, a different story is emerging. The early days of the tournament suggest that smaller nations are no longer content with being spectators in a competition they qualified for. They are competing, frustrating established powers and, in some cases, genuinely threatening to reshape the global football hierarchy. The expansion of the World Cup from 32 to 48 teams may have attracted criticism when FIFA first announced it, but the opening phase of the tournament is already providing evidence that a larger stage can create opportunities for countries that were previously denied a place in football's biggest spectacle.

The strongest argument in favour of the expanded format is visibility. Smaller nations have long possessed talent, organisation and ambition, but lacked consistent exposure against elite opposition. The 48-team structure has brought new entrants and emerging football cultures into the spotlight. Cape Verde's remarkable 0-0 draw against Spain is perhaps the most striking example. A nation making its World Cup debut held one of the world's traditional powers scoreless, thanks largely to a heroic performance by veteran goalkeeper Vozinha. The result earned Cape Verde its first World Cup point and instantly became one of the stories of the tournament. Equally noteworthy was Egypt's 1-1 draw with Belgium. The Africans not only matched the Europeans for long periods but also looked capable of taking all three points before Belgium's late equaliser. Egypt's display was a reminder that the gap between football's so-called elite and the chasing pack has narrowed considerably. New Zealand, another nation rarely associated with World Cup success, produced arguably one of the finest performances in its history by twice taking the lead against Iran before settling for a 2-2 draw. Their coach described it as among the best displays of his tenure, and despite the disappointment of surrendering the lead, the result showed that New Zealand belong on football's biggest stage. Morocco's opening draw with Brazil further reinforced the point. While Brazil remain among the favourites, Morocco's ability to secure a result against such opposition reflects the momentum generated by their remarkable rise in recent years.

These outcomes are not isolated accidents. They reflect deeper structural changes within world football. Coaching knowledge is no longer concentrated in a handful of European nations. Data analytics, sports science, scouting networks and professional academies have spread across continents. Footballers from smaller countries now play in elite leagues across Europe, Asia and the Americas. Consequently, the technical and tactical gap between nations ranked 10th and 60th is far smaller than it was two decades ago. The World Cup expansion has simply provided a platform for this reality to become visible. The tournament's new format also increases opportunities for progression. With 12 groups and 32 teams advancing to the knockout rounds, nations no longer require near-perfect campaigns to survive the group stage. The possibility of advancing as one of the best third-placed teams creates realistic ambitions for countries that previously entered the competition knowing that one defeat could effectively end their campaign.

There is also a broader lesson here for global sport. Critics feared that a larger World Cup would dilute quality. The evidence so far points in the opposite direction. Several of the tournament's most compelling matches have involved nations outside football's traditional power structure. A historic day in which multiple group-stage matches ended in draws highlighted how competitive many contests have become. The unpredictability generated by emerging nations is precisely what makes sport compelling. Fans do not remember tournaments solely for dominant victories by favourites; they remember underdogs who challenged expectations. From Cameroon in 1990 to South Korea in 2002, Costa Rica in 2014 and Morocco in 2022, World Cups have repeatedly demonstrated that football's appeal lies in its capacity to surprise. The early stages of 2026 suggest that the next chapter of that tradition may be even richer.

None of this guarantees that a smaller nation will lift the trophy next month. The financial resources, squad depth and experience of traditional powers remain enormous advantages. Over seven knockout matches, elite nations are still more likely to prevail. Yet success in modern football can no longer be measured solely by winning championships. For countries such as Cape Verde, New Zealand, Egypt, Morocco and others, the ability to compete on equal terms against established giants is itself a transformation. More importantly, these performances inspire future generations, attract investment in grassroots football and strengthen national sporting cultures. The 2026 World Cup is demonstrating that expansion is not merely about adding teams; it is about broadening belief. For decades, smaller nations dreamed of reaching the World Cup. Today, many arrive believing they can shape it. That shift may prove to be the tournament's most enduring legacy.

BHARAT KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT
THE WRITER IS CHAIRPERSON, BHARAT KI SOCH

The Ramayan remembers Kaikeyi not as a simple villain, but as a powerful queen whose judgement collapsed under insecurity and manipulation

The Ramayan does not preserve only the lives of those who stood as ideals of courage, sacrifice and righteousness. It also preserves the stories of those whose choices became warnings for society. Kaikeyi belongs to this difficult and important category. She was not without love, dignity or influence. She was the wife of King Dasharath, the mother of Bharat and one of the most powerful queens of Ayodhya. Yet her name is remembered largely through one decision that changed the destiny of the kingdom and sent Ram, the embodiment of dharma, into fourteen years of exile. Her story reminds us that affection alone is not enough. Love becomes meaningful only when it is guided by fairness, restraint and moral clarity.

Kaikeyi was not introduced as a figure of weakness. In many tellings of the Ramayan, she is remembered as a capable and courageous queen who once helped Dasharath in a moment of danger, after which he granted her two boons. This episode is important because her later error did not arise from insignificance. She had once earned trust. She had honour in the royal household. She possessed affection, access and influence. The Ramayan reminds us that individuals are rarely simply good or bad. Kaikeyi was a respected queen whose moment of weakness changed history. Past merit and high position do not protect anyone from moral failure. Character has to be renewed through right judgement at every decisive moment.

The turning point begins not with hatred, but with negative counsel. When Ayodhya was preparing for Ram's coronation, Manthara unsettled Kaikeyi's mind. She suggested that Ram's rise would reduce Bharat's future, that Kausalya would become supreme and that Kaikeyi would lose her place in the palace. Manthara did not place a weapon in Kaikeyi's hand. She placed fear in her mind. The influence of negative advisors can distort even capable minds. Leaders must seek diverse opinions, encourage honest dissent and create an environment where truth can be spoken without fear. A leader who listens only to flattery soon loses the ability to distinguish concern from manipulation.

Kaikeyi's failure was not that she loved Bharat. A mother's concern for her child is natural and powerful. Her failure was that she allowed fear to decide what love required. She wanted security for Bharat, but did not ask whether his future could be built upon injustice to Ram. Her concern became comparison. Her love became ambitions. Her mind moved from protecting her son to excluding another. Decisions driven



Kaikeyi's choices offer a timeless lesson on leadership, influence and the dangers of allowing fear to masquerade as care

by fear rather than values may appear protective in the moment, but they often damage the very people and institutions they seek to secure. Leaders must recognise how fear and ego can distort strategic decisions.

Once her mind was clouded, Kaikeyi turned to the two boons that Dasharath had granted her long ago. By the force of this word, she had the right to ask for them. Yet the Ramayan shows that dharma is never satisfied by entitlement alone. A promise may create obligation, but conscience must still guide its use. By asking for Bharat's coronation and Ram's exile, Kaikeyi used a legitimate promise for a deeply disruptive purpose. Unrestricted boons have consequences. What is available by promise is not always justified by dharma. Ethical conduct is not measured only by whether one has the right or power to act, but by whether that action upholds fairness, protects trust and serves the larger good.

Dasharath's agony also shows the danger of power without safeguards. He was bound by his word, but broken by its outcome. A father's heart was torn between promise and affection. Ayodhya, which had been preparing for celebration, was thrown into grief. Ram, Sita and Lakshman were sent into hardship. Institutions cannot depend only on personal virtue, emotion or informal promises. They need checks and balances, governance mechanisms and the courage to challenge flawed decisions before they become irreversible. A

kingdom, organisation or family weakens when one unchecked demand can disturb the larger order.

This is where Kaikeyi's story moves beyond the palace and becomes relevant to every institution. Great institutions are not destroyed by external enemies alone. They can be weakened from within when personal ambition, flattery, fear and poor governance overpower values and collective purpose. Ayodhya was not conquered from outside at that moment. It was shaken from within because affection lost balance, advice lost integrity and authority lacked restraint. This remains true in modern public life, corporate life and family life. Decline often begins when people close to power stop speaking honestly and start protecting personal interests.

The conduct of Ram gives the story its moral contrast. When informed of his exile, Ram did not rebel against Dasharath, condemn Kaikeyi or cling to the throne. He accepted the command with composure because he understood duty beyond personal entitlement. His response does not make Kaikeyi's demand right, but it shows how dharma can be preserved even when others fail in judgement. Ram's restraint teaches that ethical strength is not dependent on favourable circumstances. A person rooted in values remains steady even when treated unfairly. Where Kaikeyi allowed fear to disturb her mind, Ram allowed duty to guide his conduct.

Bharat's response is equally important. Kaikeyi acted for his supposed benefit, yet Bharat refused to accept the throne gained through injustice. His grief and anger became a moral judgement upon the very act meant to favour him. The son for whom she demanded power rejected the method by which that power was secured. Bharat's conduct reminds us that love cannot be honoured through unrighteous means. A benefit secured through unfairness becomes a burden to the person who receives it. True inheritance is not power gained at any cost, but values transmitted with integrity.

Kaikeyi's later remorse gives her story a deeply human dimension. She is not remembered only because she made a grave mistake, but because her mistake forces society to examine the fragile boundary between love and attachment, advice and manipulation, promise and justice, ambition and dharma. Her regret shows the return of conscience, but it also reveals the limits of remorse. Some consequences cannot be immediately undone, even when the heart recognises its error. Wisdom lies in preventing moral failure before it takes form. The deeper discipline is to pause before decisions harden and to question whether fear is disguising itself as care.

For modern society, Kaikeyi's story is profoundly relevant. It teaches that families, institutions and nations must not rely only on the assumed goodness of individuals. Institutions must be designed not merely around the virtue of individuals, but around systems that prevent good people from making harmful decisions. It is not enough to choose capable people around a leader. One must create a culture where truth can be spoken, motives are examined and the mission of the institution comes before personal attachment.

Kaikeyi therefore stands not as a figure to be dismissed only with anger, but as a civilisational warning to be understood with seriousness. From her, we learn that affection has value only when it is guided by dharma. We learn that influence must be governed by responsibility, ambition must be restrained by conscience, and love must be disciplined by justice. The lesson of Kaikeyi is that fear can disguise itself as care, insecurity can disguise itself as duty, and personal desire can disguise itself as protection. Her mistake changed the destiny of Ayodhya, but her story continues to guide Bharat. In the end, Kaikeyi teaches us that the mind must be guarded before action is taken, because even love can cause harm when it loses the guidance of dharma.

Views expressed are personal

PM-VBRY



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India's journey towards becoming a developed nation will depend on our ability to harness the full potential of our human capital

India's greatest strength today is not its market size, its digital infrastructure, or even its rapidly growing economy. It is its people.

Every month, thousands of young Indians step out of classrooms, training centres and colleges carrying aspirations that extend far beyond securing a job. They seek dignity, financial independence, opportunities for growth and a chance to contribute meaningfully to the nation's progress. Whether India's demographic advantage becomes a lasting economic dividend will depend on how successfully we create pathways for these aspirations to translate into productive employment.

As India advances towards the vision of Viksit Bharat @ 2047, the challenge before us is no longer merely creating skills. It is creating opportunities where those skills can be productively utilised. This is precisely where the Pradhan Mantri Viksit Bharat Rozgar Yojana (PM-VBRY) marks an important shift in thinking.

Backed by an outlay of nearly Rs 1 lakh crore, PM-VBRY is not just another employment programme. It is a recognition that sustainable job creation cannot happen through government intervention alone. Employers must become active participants in building India's human capital. The scheme creates a framework where government and industry work together towards a shared objective: generating formal employment at scale.

For industry, this is more than a policy incentive. It is an invitation to become a partner in one of the most important nation-building exercises of our time.

Moving from Training to Employment

India has invested heavily in skill development over the last decade. Millions of young people have received vocational training, technical certifications and professional qualifications. Yet



With an outlay of nearly Rs 1 lakh crore, PM-VBRY marks a shift from training-centric policymaking to employment-led growth

many employers continue to report shortages of job-ready talent, while young job seekers often struggle to find opportunities that match their skills. This disconnect highlights a simple reality. Skills have value only when they are linked to employment.

PM-VBRY addresses this challenge by shifting the focus from training alone to employment outcomes, placing employers at the centre of workforce development. By aligning workforce development with actual market demand, PM-VBRY creates a stronger bridge between learning and livelihood.

Supporting Young Indians at the Start of Their Careers

The transition from education to employment is often the most uncertain phase in a young person's life. Many first-time workers face financial pressures, relocation expenses and the challenge of adapting to formal workplaces.

Recognising these realities, PM-VBRY provides direct support to first-time employees earning up to Rs 1 lakh per month. Eligible workers receive financial assistance of up to Rs 15,000 through Direct Benefit Transfer, along with mandatory financial literacy training. For many young workers, particularly those entering the formal workforce for the

first time, this support serves as a confidence booster. It reinforces the value of formal employment and encourages long-term participation in the organised economy.

At a broader level, it helps strengthen workforce retention during the crucial early stages of employment, benefiting both employees and employers.

Making Job Creation Easier for Employers

While discussions on employment often focus on job seekers, businesses also face challenges when expanding their workforce. Recruitment, onboarding, compliance requirements and initial training involve significant investments. For many enterprises, especially smaller firms, these costs can act as barriers to hiring.

PM-VBRY addresses this concern by sharing part of the burden with employers. The scheme offers wage-linked incentives of up to Rs 3,000 per month for every additional employee hired and retained beyond a specified period. By reducing the cost of creating net new jobs, the government effectively becomes a partner in workforce expansion. This approach reflects a deeper understanding of how employment is generated in the real economy. By lowering hiring costs, PM-VBRY encourages enterprises to expand their

formal workforce with greater confidence, while simultaneously aligning business growth with national development objectives.

A Strategic Push for Manufacturing

One of the most noteworthy features of PM-VBRY is its emphasis on manufacturing. India's aspiration to become a global manufacturing hub requires large-scale employment generation. The scheme provides a special incentive by extending employer support for manufacturing establishments from two years to four years. This additional support is more than a financial concession. It reflects a strategic commitment to strengthening India's industrial ecosystem.

Manufacturing jobs often create ripple effects throughout the economy. A single factory job generates demand for logistics, transportation, maintenance services, local commerce and numerous ancillary activities. The employment impact extends far beyond the factory gate. Moreover, the extended support period enables employers to invest more confidently in structured on-the-job training programmes. Young workers gain practical exposure, industry experience and career pathways that classroom learning alone cannot provide.

Driving Inclusive Growth Through Formalisation

The true success of India's growth story will ultimately be measured by how many people are able to participate in it. One of the most encouraging aspects of PM-VBRY is its potential to deepen formalisation and broaden economic inclusion.

The scheme leverages existing digital infrastructure, including Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) systems, Aadhaar-linked accounts and digital compliance mechanisms, making participation simple and transparent. Benefits flow automatically through regular

employer filings, reducing administrative burdens and minimising delays.

Importantly, the scheme is designed to include small and medium enterprises alongside larger corporations. Even businesses with relatively small workforces can qualify for incentives by creating a modest number of additional jobs. This design ensures that employment growth is not concentrated only in major metropolitan centres or large enterprises. It creates opportunities across regions, industries and enterprise sizes.

For young workers, formal employment means much more than a monthly salary. It brings access to social security, provident fund benefits, insurance protection and long-term financial stability. In that sense, PM-VBRY is not merely creating jobs, but ensuring economic security.

A Partnership for Viksit Bharat

India's journey towards becoming a developed nation will depend on our ability to harness the full potential of our human capital. Governments can provide policy direction and financial support. Industry can provide jobs, training and workplace opportunities. Neither can succeed fully without the other.

PM-VBRY represents an important acknowledgement of this reality. It places employer participation at the heart of workforce development and recognises that employment generation is a shared responsibility.

India's demographic dividend is often described as a once-in-a-generation opportunity. PM-VBRY provides the framework to convert that opportunity into tangible outcomes. If government and industry continue to work together with the same sense of purpose, we can build not only a larger economy, but a more skilled, more confident and more prosperous India.

Views expressed are personal

AS RUSSIA-UKRAINE WAR DRAGS ON

G7 allies scramble to push Ukraine back to atop of Trump’s agenda

EVIAN-LES-BAINS: US allies at the Group of Seven summit of major industrialised democracies worked Tuesday to push the war in Ukraine back up the agenda of President Donald Trump after more than four years of fighting sparked by Russia's full-scale invasion.

The Iran conflict has in recent weeks overshadowed Ukraine, but following his announcement of an agreement to end the 3 1/2-month-old conflict in the Gulf, Trump said he now wants to focus on Ukraine.

Trump said Iran will soon be “back in the rearview mirror.”

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy joined G7 leaders for a morning working session. Talks wrapped quickly, as leaders gathered for just 75 minutes. According to a French diplomat familiar with the talks, G7 leaders, including Trump, agreed to increase pressure on Russia, notably through sanctions targeting its oil and natural gas sectors. The diplomat, who spoke



The diplomat said G7 leaders held a ‘very fruitful’ conversation on Ukraine

on condition of anonymity on ongoing talks in Evian, said G7 leaders held a “very fruitful” conversation on Ukraine.

Leaders also agreed on a common position to support Ukraine by providing addi-

tional air defence capabilities and other means of protection, the diplomat said. As the US under Trump has cut back aid to Ukraine, France and its European allies are now the biggest providers of military

and financial support to Kyiv.

In the French spa town close to the Swiss border, Trump downplayed the impact of the Russia-Ukraine war on the US but lamented the death toll. “The whole thing is ridic-

Highlights

- » President Trump said Iran will soon be ‘back in the rearview mirror’
- » Leaders also agreed on a common position to support Ukraine by providing additional air defence capabilities
- » Trump has been frustrated by a lack of movement toward Ukraine-Russia resolution

ulous,” Trump said. “So, yeah, I’m going to do whatever I can.”

Meanwhile, the UK announced a new set of sanctions targeting the “shadow fleet” Russia uses to ship oil and gas, and the finance networks used by Moscow to evade Western sanctions. The ships targeted include several vessels recently purchased by Russia to transport liquefied natural gas from its sanctioned Arctic LNG 2 project. AGENCIES

Israel takes more territory, kills two people in Gaza, reports say

CAIRO/GAZA: An Israeli strike killed at least two Palestinians in the central Gaza Strip, health officials said, as residents of an area in the north of the enclave fled their homes after Israeli forces expanded their control in the territory.

Medics said an Israeli strike near a residential building in the Nuseirat refugee camp, in the central Gaza Strip, killed two brothers, Ahmed and Mahmoud Abu Heen. The Israeli military did not immediately comment. An October 2025 truce, opens new tab brokered by U.S. President Donald Trump has so far failed to halt Israeli attacks in Gaza or to secure the disarmament of Hamas militants.

The new deaths brought to nearly 1,000 the number of Palestinians killed by Israeli fire since October, according to the Gaza health ministry. Israel says four of its soldiers have been killed by militants in that period.

The violence comes as Nickolay Mladenov, Trump’s Board of Peace envoy for Gaza, arrived in Cairo to pursue talks that mediators from Egypt, Qatar and Turkey have held with Hamas leaders over implementing the second phase of



Palestinians clear the rubble of a building that was destroyed in an Israeli airstrike, at al-Maghazi refugee camp

“THE VIOLENCE COMES AS NICKOLAY MLADENOV, TRUMP’S BOARD OF PEACE ENVOY FOR GAZA, ARRIVED IN CAIRO TO PURSUE TALKS”

Israel troops still control more than 60% of Gaza’s territory, where they have ordered residents out and destroyed remaining buildings.

On May 28, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu reaffirmed that he had directed Israel’s military to expand its hold and take control of 70% of the enclave. Witnesses in southern Gaza have said Israeli forces have in the past few days expanded the “Yellow Zone” - the areas they control - in eastern Khan Younis and northern Rafah, where new markers and concrete blocks have been placed. AGENCIES

China, Nepal FMs hold ‘comprehensive’ talks

BEIJING: China’s Foreign Minister Wang Yi and his Nepalese counterpart Shisir Khanal held “comprehensive talks” covering the entire gamut of bilateral ties, including border management, connectivity and trade.

Khanal arrived in Beijing on a four-day visit on June 14 after his weeklong trip to India.

After he met with Wang Yi on Monday, Khanal said in a post on X. “We held a comprehensive discussion on the entire gamut of bilateral relations, including in the areas of connectivity, border management, trade, technology transfer and multilateral cooperation.” “We also exchanged views

on expanding people-to-people ties and reaffirmed shared commitment to further strengthening Nepal-China relations for the mutual benefit of our two countries,” he said.

At the meeting, Wang Yi said China has always placed its relations with Nepal in an important position in its neighbourhood diplomacy and pursues a friendly policy toward all Nepalese people.

China will, as always, support Nepal in safeguarding its national sovereignty, independence and territorial integrity, and in exploring a development path suited to its own national conditions, Wang Yi said. AGENCIES

‘Higher prices for gas, groceries & flights will outlast Iran war’

Businesses expect higher costs to linger, which means their customers might need to prepare for that too

NEW YORK: A tentative deal to end the Iran war makes it reasonable to ask how soon prices will drop for gasoline, groceries, airline tickets and other items that got more expensive during the conflict.

Not so fast, experts say. Even after oil starts flowing again from the Middle East, it could take a while for consumers to see a difference at local fuel pumps, supermarkets and other places they shop, according to economists and industry analysts.

Fighting over the Strait of Hormuz disrupted not only supplies of crude and refined fuel but also the supply chains for fertiliser, food and even



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

footwear. Businesses expect higher costs to linger, which means their customers might need to prepare for that too.

“It is not clear, despite three months of war, that anything

has been achieved that makes the American consumer better off,” Brett House, an economist who teaches at Columbia Business School, said. “In fact, by almost any measure, not

Refineries typically pay for crude oil a month or more in advance, so even after oil prices drop, they won’t immediately be processing cheaper products

just the American consumer, but the world, is worse off as a result of this attack.”

If the deal between the US and Iran holds, here’s how experts see the war’s effects

receding — or not — in the weeks ahead: Following news of the tentative agreement, oil prices fell Monday to about \$80 for a barrel of US benchmark crude. That compares to \$67-per-barrel before the war, and the price of over \$120 a barrel reached earlier in the conflict.

Refineries typically pay for crude oil a month or more in advance, so even after oil prices drop, they won’t immediately be processing cheaper products.

“The tendency of gasoline prices to fall slowly is partly because the raw material takes weeks to work through the system until it’s delivered to con-

sumers,” said Michael Lynch, a distinguished fellow at the nonpartisan Energy Policy Research Foundation.

In places without enough refining capacity to meet their needs, such as the West Coast of the US, gas prices will take longer to drop, said Mark Barreau, a professor of chemical engineering and chemistry at Texas A&M University.

In some Asian and African countries that rely more on oil from the Middle East, the supply shock led to school and government office closures and instructions to work from home, according to the International Energy Agency. AGENCIES

Sport

Underdogs with a bite

The big upsets at WC so far have been matches ending at 0-0, 1-1 and 2-2

MIAMI GARDENS: The teams that are ranked 61st, 67th and 85th in FIFA’s world rankings all were heavy underdogs in their first matches at the World Cup.

They all played Monday. None of them won. None of them lost, either.

Through five days and 16 matches of soccer’s biggest extravaganza ever, the underdogs are proving to be very tough to beat. All four matches on Monday ended in ties — the most in a single day of men’s World Cup play since 1958 — and all of them technically could be considered upsets as well.

The biggest win (that wasn’t a win) of all saw Cape Verde — ranked No. 67 and in its World Cup debut — hold No. 2 Spain, a favourite to win the whole thing, 0-0 in what easily has been the biggest shocker of the tournament to this point. “It means everything,” said Cape Verde coach Pedro Leitão Brito, who simply goes by Bubiata.

The other Monday results: — No. 85 New Zealand, the lowest-ranked team out of the 48 qualifiers entering the World Cup, tied No. 20 Iran 2-2. — No. 61 Saudi Arabia tied No. 16 Uruguay 1-1. — No. 29 Egypt tied No. 9 Belgium 1-1.



The biggest shock has been Cape Verde’s brilliant rearguard effort against Spain in 0-0 draw

AP

For Monday’s underdogs, the ties were a pretty big deal. But even they knew what the Cape Verde score meant in the grand scheme of things.

“The draw involving Spain,” Saudi Arabia coach Georgios Donis said, “may be the biggest surprise in this World Cup.”

Four years ago, the Saudis opened with a shocking win over eventual champion Argentina.

The World Cup isn’t like the NCAA tournament. Nobody is eliminated or assured of advancing no matter the outcome of their first match. But if

4
Four matches ended in draws at the World Cup on Monday for the first time since 1958

this event was more like March Madness, it’s certain that plenty of brackets would already be

busted.

Spain was -1500 to beat Cape Verde according to odds posted just before the match started Monday. Those are overwhelming odds, ones that mean bettors would have had to wager \$1,500 just to profit \$100. And oddsmakers in Las Vegas said Spain was picked to win in a slew of parlays, all of which were quickly doomed.

“This shows how difficult it is to play (the first game) in a World Cup,” Uruguay’s Maxi Araújo said. “We’ve seen that they are difficult — not only in our group, but in many

groups.” He’s right. And there’s not much margin of error now in Groups F and H.

Teams are guaranteed three group-stage matches at the World Cup, one against each of the other three teams in their group. The top two finishers in each of the 12 groups are assured of reaching the knockout stage; the eight best third-place teams also will advance.

But in Group F (New Zealand, Iran, Belgium and Egypt) and Group H (Uruguay, Saudi Arabia, Spain and Cape Verde), everyone has exactly one point with two matches left. Teams get three points for a win, no points for a loss. “A lot of positives to build on,” New Zealand’s Elijah Just said.

The upsets-that-were-ties trend didn’t start Monday. There were two other significant ones earlier in the tournament: No. 56 Qatar tied No. 19 Switzerland 1-1, and No. 64 Bosnia and Herzegovina tied No. 30 Canada 1-1. Through the first 16 matches, eight ended in ties. The other two weren’t exactly of the shocking variety: No. 18 Japan were slight underdogs going into their 2-2 tie with No. 8 Netherlands, and No. 6 Brazil and No. 7 Morocco — as would be expected, given how close they are in the world rankings — tied 1-1. AGENCIES

PALM BEACH GARDENS: It would have been unthinkable at the start of the 2022 World Cup to suggest Cristiano Ronaldo was anything other than the undisputed leader of the Portugal team.

But the Qatar edition went poorly for Portugal’s all-time leading goal scorer. After scoring just once, from the penalty spot, in the group stage, he reacted angrily to being subbed off against South Korea and was promptly dropped to the bench for his team’s first knockout-stage match against Switzerland.

Then, he didn’t score at all in the 2024 European Championship. It was the first time he had failed to find the net at a major international tournament.

Now, in the build-up to what may be Ronaldo’s World Cup swansong, concerns over what the 41-year-old can still bring to the national team are at the forefront of many fans’ minds. Portugal open play Wednesday against Congo DR in Houston.

“I think in some instances they play better without him,” fan Zach Mallias said at the team’s first open World Cup practice at its Florida base camp. “There are other players that fit the system better.”

Other fans are worried



Portugal’s Cristiano Ronaldo runs drills during a training session

AP

His abundant experience and leadership are qualities some supporters say cannot be replicated

about the superstar’s ego and whether he would accept relinquishing the spotlight for the good of the team.

“He’s a very big player, he’s very loved by a lot of his fans,” Beatrice Mitankin said. “It might get to his head.”

There is some recent evidence, however, of Ronaldo still

being able to positively influence games. During Portugal’s 2025 UEFA Nations League run, its second title triumph in that competition, he scored eight goals, including an equalizer in the final against Spain.

Ronaldo also recently won his first Saudi Pro League title with Al-Nassr, leading his club with 28 goals on the season.

Although his age has repeatedly been called into question, fan Ernesto Vilar pointed to other examples of older players, like Argentina’s Lionel Messi and Croatia’s Luka Modrić, as veterans who still play significant roles for their team.

“Age is just a number,” Vilar said. “He’s still in very peak physical condition.” AGENCIES

Nations Cup: India pass Japan test, enter semis

AUCKLAND: The Indian women’s hockey team booked its place in the semifinals of the FIH Nations Cup with a hard-fought 2-1 victory over Japan, courtesy goals from captain Salima Tete and Lalremsiami here on Tuesday.

The win was India’s second in Pool A of the tournament, which serves as a qualifier for

next year’s FIH Pro League. With six points from two matches, India secured a spot in the last four.

India broke the deadlock in the third quarter, with skipper Salima Tete scoring in the 33rd minute after sustained pressure from the forwards. Japan equalised two minutes later through Ai Hiramitsu. AGENCIES

After Pakistan high, India chase batting rhythm against Netherlands

LEEDS: India will aim to put an improved performance with the bat when they face Netherlands in their second group game of the Women’s T20 World Cup here on Wednesday.

Smriti Mandhana at the top and Richa Ghosh in the lower order made the difference with the bat in the opener against Pakistan.

The rest of the batting lineup, including opener Shafali Verma and Harmanpreet Kaur,

could not come to the party.

Bharti Fulmali plays a crucial role in the middle-order but she had a forgettable first outing in the ICC event.

More consistency is needed from the Indian batters for the tougher battles ahead in the league stage.

The Netherlands game should be cakewalk but India would need to beat either Australia or South Africa in the league stage to qualify for the



Smriti Mandhana will look to iron out some flaws

AP

“I saw them before our Pakistan match. They are good bowlers

— Richa Ghosh, India’s wicketkeeper

semifinals. The fielding against Paki-

stan was not up to the mark, to start with, but some good catches were taken later in the innings. Both the pacers, Arundhati Reddy and Kranti Gaud, were not able to make an impact. They both would be looking for early breakthroughs at Headingley. The spin duo of Deepti Sharma and Shree Charani shared eight wickets amongst themselves with the former picking up a five-wicket haul. AGENCIES

AFTER US SUPREME COURT DECLINES REVIEW

TCS to set aside \$70 mn more in CSC-DXC Tech legal dispute

TCS said it has already provided \$150 million for the matter in its books of accounts in accordance with applicable accounting standards

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) on Tuesday said it would make provision of additional \$70 million in the first quarter of fiscal 2027 after the US Supreme Court declined to review a lower court ruling in a legal dispute with Computer Sciences Corporation (CSC), now part of DXC Technology.

TCS, in the BSE filing, said it has already provided \$150 million for the matter in its books of accounts in accordance with applicable accounting standards. The company “will make necessary provision now for the incremental amount of \$70 million towards damages, interest and legal cost, as a one-time exceptional expense, in Q1 FY2027.”

TCS had disclosed the litigation in earlier exchange filings in June 2024 and November 2025. Providing an update over the suit filed by CSC/DXC Technology Company, TCS, on Tuesday, informed that US Supreme Court has declined to review a lower court ruling in a lawsuit brought by CSC.



TCS had disclosed the litigation in earlier exchange filings in June 2024 and November 2025

“In continuation of our earlier communication...dated June 14, 2024 and...dated November 22, 2025, we wish to inform you that the United States Supreme Court has denied our petition for a writ of certiorari to review the judgment of the United States Court of Appeals for the Fifth Circuit on June 15, 2026, in the above matter,” it said.

Earlier, TCS had faced a legal setback after the US Court of Appeals for the Fifth Cir-

cuit upheld a \$194.2 million damages award and ruled in favour of Computer Sciences Corporation in a years-long trade secrets case.

Back in June 2024, TCS had updated BSE about receipt of an “adverse judgement” passed by United States District Court, Northern District of Texas, Dallas Division. The company had, at that time, stated it has strong arguments in the matter and that it intends to defend its posi-

Highlights

- » As per that filing, the court also assessed that the company is liable for \$25.7 million in prejudgment interest through June 13, 2024
- » Another filing/update followed in Nov 2025 where TCS informed the US Court of Appeals for Fifth Circuit has issued an adverse ruling in the matter and confirmed the District Court decision on damages

interest through June 13, 2024.

“Under the terms of the Court orders, the company is liable for misappropriation of trade secrets under the Defend Trade Secrets Act of 2016 (DTSA),” it said. Another filing/update followed in November 2025 where TCS informed the United States Court of Appeals for the Fifth Circuit has issued an adverse ruling in the matter and confirmed the District Court decision on damages.

“However, the Court has vacated the previously granted injunction and directed the United States District Court, Northern District of Texas, Dallas Division, to reassess the injunction order basis direction of the Appeals Court,” the filing, in late 2025, had mentioned.

At that point, the company said it is evaluating various options, including review and appeal before the appropriate courts, and intends to vigorously defend its position and that necessary provisions related to this matter will be duly made in the books of accounts and financial statements in accordance with applicable accounting standards.

Two of Adani’s Airports included in World’s Most Beautiful Airports List

NEW DELHI: Two airports operated by Adani Group have been included in the Prix Versailles World’s Most Beautiful Airports List 2026, highlighting growing global recognition of India’s aviation infrastructure.

Prix Versailles, an international architecture and design award presented at UNESCO headquarters in Paris, selected Navi Mumbai International Airport’s Terminal 1 and Terminal 2 at Guwahati’s Lokpriya Gopinath Bordoloi International Airport among the world’s seven most beautiful airports this year.

The awards recognise excellence in architecture, sustainability, innovation, cultural identity and passenger experience. Navi Mumbai International Airport was honoured for its lotus-inspired design by renowned architecture firm Zaha Hadid Architects and its integration of technology and sustainability. The recognition comes as the airport prepares for a phased operational ramp-up & expansion of aviation capacity in the Mumbai metropolitan region.

Guwahati Airport’s Terminal 2 was recognised for a design inspired by the Bamboo Orchid, reflecting the biodiversity and cultural heritage of Northeast India. The terminal incorporates sustainable features, including bamboo elements, passive daylighting and biophilic design.

According to Prix Versailles, Navi Mumbai airport combines futuristic architecture with operational functionality, while its digital art programme enhances the passenger experience through interactive



Interior of the newly-built Navi Mumbai International Airport

The recognition comes as the airport prepares for a phased operational ramp-up and expansion of aviation capacity in the Mumbai metropolitan region

The Guwahati terminal was praised for embracing regional identity through indigenous art, tribal narratives and local craftsmanship embedded within its interiors. Its sweeping vaulted ceilings and fluid design patterns draw inspiration from Assam’s landscapes and the Brahmaputra river system.

The inclusion of both airports reflects the efforts of Adani Airport Holdings Ltd to develop large-scale aviation infrastructure with a strong focus on design, sustainability.

Other airports on the 2026 list are located in Guangzhou, Frankfurt, Kandal Stueng, Pittsburgh and San Diego. Three airports from the shortlist will later receive Prix Versailles global titles for architecture, interior or exterior design. AGENCIES

Adani Ports expands tie-up with Kaleris, to invest \$100 mn in AI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ) on Tuesday said it has expanded its strategic partnership with US-based global software company Kaleris, and will invest up to \$100 million in two phases to accelerate automation and optimisation.

In a statement, APSEZ said this \$100 million is part of the \$850 million investment the company plans in technology and decarbonisation under its 2031 ambition.

Building on Phase 1 deployments across six ports, APSEZ will now scale advanced operating, optimisation and automation capabilities across its maritime and logistics network, the statement added.

As part of the multi-year agreement, Kaleris will deploy its foundational terminal operating system and AI-augmented advanced container handling and optimisation solutions across 15 APSEZ container terminals spanning nine domestic and international ports.

The deployment is expected to deliver tangible efficiency gains — up to 20 per cent improvement in Rubber Tyred Gantry (RTG) crane productivity, and up to 14 per cent improvement in terminal truck

productivity. APSEZ whole-time Director and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Ashwani Gupta said, “AI-enabled automation will define the next frontier of competitiveness in ports and logistics.”

While APSEZ has already deployed an end-to-end digital platform from shore-to-door that provides seamless track-and-trace and integrated command-and-control capabilities, the Kaleris integration will enhance productivity, improve turnaround time, and consistently deliver a superior customer experience, Gupta added.

Kirk Knauff, President and CEO, Kaleris, said: “APSEZ is demonstrating the real impact of an AI-enabled port network at scale. Expanding to all 15 terminals reflects the results already achieved and the trust behind this partnership.”

As cargo volumes grow and supply chains become more complex, APSEZ is investing in artificial intelligence (AI), the Internet of Things (IoT), computer vision and advanced optimisation tools to enable real-time visibility, smarter resource allocation and faster decision-making.

KIND ATTENTION : RAIL PASSENGERS! RUN OF SUMMER SPECIAL TRAIN

For the convenience of passengers, Railways have decided to run following Summer Special Train as per schedule given below :-

09611/09612 Ajmer Jn.-Yog Nagari Rishikesh- Ajmer Jn. Special Express (Weekly)				10 Trips	
Train No. 09611	STATIONS		Train No. 09612		
ARR. DEP.			ARR. DEP.		
— 19:45	Ajmer Jn.		09:55 —		
20:18 20:20	Kishangarh		08:17 08:19		
20:45 20:47	Phulera Jn.		07:30 07:32		
21:50 22:00	Jaipur		06:35 06:45		
22:11 22:14	Gandhi Nagar Jaipur		06:04 06:07		
22:40 22:42	Dausa		04:36 04:38		
23:13 23:15	Bandikui Jn.		04:13 04:15		
23:25 23:27	Rajgarh		03:52 03:54		
00:01 00:04	Alwar		03:24 03:27		
00:24 00:26	Khairthal		03:06 03:08		
02:48 02:50	Rewari		02:30 02:32		
03:28 03:30	Gurgaon		01:22 01:24		
03:45 03:47	Delhi Cantt.		01:00 01:02		
04:30 04:45	Delhi Jn.		00:15 00:30		
07:30 07:32	Sharnli		21:40 21:45		
08:28 08:30	Rampur Maniharan		20:57 20:59		
10:18 10:20	Tapri Jn.		20:33 20:35		
11:04 11:06	Roorkee		19:43 19:45		
11:50 11:55	Haridwar		18:58 19:03		
12:50 —	Yog Nagari Rishikesh		— 17:55		

Day of run:- 09611 Ex. Ajmer Jn. from 17.06.2026 to 15.07.2026 (every Wednesday) 09612 Ex. Yog Nagari Rishikesh from 18.06.2026 to 16.07.2026 (every Thursday)

Accommodation : 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General

For detailed information, please call RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit enquiry website: www.enquiry.indianrail.gov.in

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SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY CORRIGENDUM

Ref : (I) Tender Notice No. 16/2026-2027 dated 30.05.2026
(ii) Tender No. 12265006 due on 29.06.2026

- In reference to above tender, the due date has been extended from 23.06.2026 to 29.06.2026.
 - In reference to above tender, CAMC has been removed from the item description under the goods category.
- All other terms & conditions remain unchanged.
- The corrigendum has been published on website www.ireps.gov.in.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2026/26

NEW OKHLA INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida G.B. Nagar,(U.P)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <http://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/ amendments & corrigendum etc.

- (A)
- 48/GM(E&M)/S.M./E/M-III/26-27, Providing Lighting Arrangement Transformer and Maintenance of Electrical Works in Noida Public Library (Noida Lok Munch) Sector-15, Noida. **Cost Rs. 16.60 Lacs.**
 - 49/GM(E&M)/S.M./E/M-III/26-27, AMC and Servicing of DG Set for Office Building Sector-19 & 20, Noida. **Cost Rs. 12.31 Lacs.**
 - 20/GM(E/M)Sr.M(E/M)-IV/2026-27, Providing Street Light Arrangement in Village Nagli Sakhpur, Nagla Nagli and Village Nagli Wazidpur Sector-130, 5% Village Abadi plot, Noida. **Cost Rs. 24.66 Lacs.**
- Which can be uploaded by date: **30.06.2026 Upto 5.00 PM.** Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- **01.07.2026 at 11.00 AM.**
- (B)
- 07/GM/AO/Sr.M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET, Annual Maintenance of Air Conditioner & Electrical work in DM Residence Cum camp office at Sec-27, Noida. **Cost Rs. 9.68 Lacs.**
 - 32/GM(E&M)/S.M./E/M-III/26-27, Electrical Beautification of B-Block Market in Sector-33, Noida. **Cost Rs. 22.15 Lacs.**
 - 07/GM(E/M)Sr.M(E/M)-IV/2026-27, Providing Lighting arrangement at Christian Kabristan Sector-94, Noida. **Cost Rs. 21.06 Lacs.**
 - 13/GM(E/M)Sr.M(E/M)-IV/2026-27, Annual Electrical Maintenance of Different Barat Ghar in Village-Kondli Bangar, Jhatta, Badoli and Ghari Samastipur, Noida. **Cost Rs. 29.87 Lacs.**
- Which can be uploaded by date:- **23.06.2026 upto 5.00 PM.** Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- **24.06.2026 at 11.00 AM.**

Office Sector-5 General Manager (E&M), Noida

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियंता, लोक निर्माण विभाग, मंडल क्रमांक 1, रायपुर (छ.ग.)
दूरभाष : (0771) 2331431 फ़ैक्स : (0771) 4055885 ईमेल : se1.raipur@gov.in

निविदा निरस्तीकरण सूचना

ज्ञाप क्र. /40-87/सा.26 रायपुर, दिनांक / /2026

इस कार्यालय द्वारा आमंत्रित निविदा SYSTEM TENDER NO: 191845 NIT No. 65

दिनांक 29.05.2026 Special Repair. M.O.W.. Annual Repair and Other Deposit Works for Different type of Building under PWD Engineering College Sub Division Sector-18, Nava Raipur Atal Nagar in Distt. Raipur (C.G.) को अपरिहार्य कारणों से निरस्त किया जाता है ।

जी.नं. — 262701148

G 262701473/7

अधीक्षण अभियंता,
लोक निर्माण विभाग,
मंडल क्रमांक 1, रायपुर (छ.ग.)

POSSESSION NOTICE

GODREJ FINANCE **GODREJ FINANCE LIMITED**
Registered office at Godrej One, Pirojshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East) Mumbai-400079 Maharashtra
Branch Office: Godrej Capital, 208 & 208 A, 2nd Floor, ABW Tower, Sector 25, Gurugram- 122002

Possession Notice (For Immovable Property)
(Rule 8(1) of The Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)
LOAN/FACILITY ACCOUNT NO. GFL3201LP0093272- LOAN AGAINST PROPERTY- LOAN GRANTED TO MR. AYAZ AHMAD AND MS. SAYRA BANO.

Whereas, the authorized officer of the Godrej Finance Limited, a Company incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013 having registration as a Finance Company from the Reserve Bank of India & having registered office at Godrej One, Pirojshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East) Mumbai-400079 Maharashtra & One of the office at Godrej Capital, R-5 Green Park (Main), New Delhi - 110016 under The Securitization And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued a demand Notice Dated **10.04.2026** calling upon Applicant/Borrower/Co-Applicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagees (1) Mr. Ayaz Ahmad and Ms. Sayra Bano to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being **Rs. 70,77,985/- (INR Seventy Lakhs Seventy-Seven Thousand Nine Hundred Eighty-Five Only)** due as on **10.04.2026** with subsequent interest, penal interest, charges, costs etc. as per the agreement(s) within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The Applicant/ Borrower/ Co-Applicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagees, having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Applicant/Borrower/ Co-Applicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagees in particular and the public in general that the undersigned authorized officer of company has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under section 13(4) of the said act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on this 15th day of June 2026.

The Applicant/ Borrower/ Co-Applicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagees attention is invited to provisions of Sub- Section (8) of Section 13 of the said act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured asset/s.

The Applicant/ Borrower/ Co-Applicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagees in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Godrej Finance Limited for the amount of **Rs. 70,77,985/- (INR Seventy Lakhs Seventy-Seven Thousand Nine Hundred Eighty-Five Only)** due as on **10.04.2026** and interest thereon from **11.04.2026**.

Description of Secured Asset/s
Property Being A Residential Freehold Plot No. 30, Area Measuring 206 Sq. Yards, Out Of Khasra No. 142, Situated In Akash Nagar Colony, Indragadi, Pargana Dasna, Tehsil And District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh
Date: 17.06.2026
Place: Ghaziabad

Authorized Officer,
Godrej Finance Limited

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA PUBLIC WORKS DIVISION, AKOLA

E-TENDER NOTICE No.06/ 2026 - 2027

Outword No.3726 / TC/ E-TN-06/ 2026 / Date- 11.06.2026

Online E-Tenders.

Online tender are invited by Executive Engineer, Public Works Division, Akola (Telephone No. 0724-2435195) e-mail-akola.ee@mahapwd.gov.in for following works No.1 to 3 for B-1 from the Competent and Interested contractors (Not Necessary Registered With P.W.D.) If Global Company having its Branch / Sub Company in India, E-Tender can be downloaded from the <https://www.mahatenders.gov.in> Other instructions can be seen in the e-tender form. Competant Authority Reserve the Right to Reject All or any one of the tender. Conditional tender will not be Accepted.

Sr. No	Name of work	Estimated Cost
1	Widening and Improvement to NH to Mhaipur MDR-28 Km 0/00 to 3/500 Tq.Akola Dist Akola (Rama 161 from one Kanheri to Sahit)	38842071
2	Improvement to Mhaising Ramgaon Daljigav Gawande Anvi Mirzapur Bargaon Manju Road MDR-12 Km 3/00 to 4/00 amd 4/500 to 6/00 and Construction of Protection Wall at 3/800 Tq.Akola Dist.Akola (Rama 280 from Mhaising to Ramgaon and Rama 284 from Kaseanpur to Rama 33 Bargaon)	22732750
3	Construction of Minor Bridge on Akola Apatapa Mhaising Road SH-280 km 7/200 in Tq.Akola Dist.Akola (From Akola to Mhaising and From Lakhpuri to Bailarkhad and From Kavath Kholapur to Asara and From Bhatkuli to Amravati Kurha Pulgaon Rama 280) :	19585240

Note :-

- All eligible/interested tenderer are requirea to be enruled on portal <https://www.mahatenders.gov.in>
- Above Work No.1 to 3 form B-1 Tender download & prepration of Bid from Dt.17.04.2026 at 10.00 Hrs to Dt.24.06.2026 at 18.00 Hrs. & E-Tender Opening Date 29.06.2026 (Fulher tender timetable as on Online)
- Pre- Tender Conference will be held on Dt.18.06.2026 at 12.00 Hrs of above work No.1 at 12.00 Hrs. in the office of the Chief Engineer, Public Works Region, Amravati
- Pre- Tender Conference will be held on Dt.18.06.2026 at 12.00 Hrs of above work No.2 & 3 at 12.00 Hrs. in the office of the Superintending Engineer, Public Works Circle,Akola
- E-Tender above work No.1 to 3 Superintending Engineer, P.W.Circle, Akola Open
- please note the further changes regarding above works will not be published through corrigendum by press notice the changes will be available only on electronic tendering system of Govt of Maharashtra which is available on the portal <https://www.mahatenders.gov.in> & Notice
- All detail information is available on following websites & Office Information Board.Visit web site for details : <https://www.mahatenders.gov.in>
- Other instructions can be seen in the tender form. All or any one of the tender may be rejected by the competent authority.
- For the above works the contractor should inspect the site along with the engineer and submit the e-tender and no additional claims will be accepted.Furthermore, payments for bills shall be released subject to the availability of funds.
- Online Schedule in Applicable and Final

(Prasad Patil)
Executive Engineer
Public Works Division, Akola

DGIPR/2026/27/1161

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



J&K Bank and Department of Pension & Pensioners' Welfare (GoI) on Tuesday launched a collaborative initiative on the sidelines of the 59th Pre-Retirement Counselling Workshop and 13th Bankers' Awareness Programme held here at the Sher-i-Kashmir International Conference Centre (SKICC), Srinagar. The MoU was signed by MD & CEO Amitava Chatterjee on behalf of J&K Bank & Joint Secretary, DoPPW, Dhruvjayoti Sengupta on behalf of the Department in the presence of Union Minister of State Dr Jitendra Singh, Secretary, DoPPW, Nivedita Shukla Verma, J&K Chief Secretary, Atal Dulloo, Bank's Chief General Manager Ashutosh Sareen and General Manager (Government Business), Khurshheed Muzaffar, MD JKB FSL Zaffar Akeel.

MPOST

‘UP, Gujarat, Jharkhand & 10 other states post revenue surplus in FY25’

Eighteen states targeted revenue surplus, 3 states targeted revenue deficit & 7 targeted zero revenue deficit in FY25, a report by CAG said

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Uttar Pradesh, Gujarat, Jharkhand, Manipur, and 9 other states recorded surplus revenues in 2024-25, while the remaining 15 states had a deficit.

Eighteen states targeted revenue surplus, 3 states targeted revenue deficit, and 7 targeted zero revenue deficit in FY 2024-25, according to a report on ‘State Finances 2024-25’ released by Comptroller and Auditor General of India K Sanjay Murthy on Tuesday.

“In FY 2024-25, 15 states were revenue-deficient while the rest 13 states were revenue surplus,” the report said.

Of the 18 states that targeted revenue surplus, 9 achieved the target, while Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Mizoram, and Telangana ended up being revenue deficit in 2024-25.

Seven states -- Goa, Jharkhand, Punjab, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu, Tripura, and Uttar Pradesh -- targeted a zero-revenue deficit.

Among them, 4 states -- Goa, Jharkhand, Tripura, and Uttar Pradesh -- achieved a revenue surplus, whereas Punjab, Rajasthan and Tamil Nadu



‘In FY25, 15 states were revenue-deficient while the rest 13 states were revenue surplus,’ the report on ‘State Finances 2024-25’ released by CAG of India said

ended the year with a revenue deficit.

Of the 15 states that were revenue-deficient in 2024-25, Himachal Pradesh, Mizoram, Punjab and West Bengal received Finance Commission revenue deficit grants.

The report further said that if the indicative fiscal deficit target of 3 per cent of the GSDP, fixed by the Fifteenth Finance Commission for 2024-25, for states’ fiscal consolidation path is considered, then 18 states were above the target.

The aggregate revenue defi-

cit of 15 revenue-deficit states, without netting revenue surplus of 13 states, stood at Rs 3,46,385 crore, which was 1.5 per cent of their combined GSDP. The net revenue deficit, after adjusting the revenue surplus in 13 states, stood at Rs 2,19,041 crore, 0.68 per cent of the combined GSDP of all 28 states.

“I hope that the publication on State Finances 2024-25 will serve as a useful evidence-based resource for governments, researchers, policymakers and citizens, enabling a deeper understanding of state finances

Highlights

» Of the 18 states that targeted revenue surplus, 9 achieved the target

» Meanwhile, Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Haryana, Himachal, Karnataka, Telangana, Maharashtra, Mizoram & ended up being revenue deficit in financial year 2024-25

» State GST constituted more than 43 per cent of the combined states’ own tax revenues

and supporting informed fiscal decision-making,” CAG Murthy said.

The publication highlights the growing importance of states’ own tax revenues, which accounted for 50 per cent of the combined total revenue receipts of Rs 40.52 lakh crore across the 28 states in 2024-25.

State GST constituted more than 43 per cent of the combined states’ own tax revenues.

The combined budgetary expenditure of all states stood at Rs 51.20 lakh crore in 2024-25, equivalent to 15.78 per cent

of their combined GSDP.

The decadal trend shows that salaries, pensions and interest payments continue to constitute a major share of revenue expenditure.

In 2024-25, such committed expenditure exceeded 43 per cent of the combined revenue expenditure of the 28 states, with significant inter-state variation — from 74 per cent in Nagaland to 29 per cent in Maharashtra.

As of March 31, 2025, the total liabilities of the states stood at Rs 90.51 lakh crore. All 28 states recorded a fiscal deficit.

A decadal analysis of deficit parameters shows that states as a whole, during the period 2015-16 to 2024-25, remained in revenue and fiscal deficit.

A substantial increase in revenue deficit took place in 2020-21, a year impacted by the Covid pandemic.

There has been a substantial increase in the fiscal deficit in 2020-21 and 2024-25.

The states which witnessed a substantial increase in fiscal deficit in 2024-25 as compared to 2023-24 were Andhra Pradesh, Assam, Gujarat, Jharkhand, Karnataka, Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Odisha, Tripura and Uttarakhand.

Goyal urges corporates, investors to invest in India before it’s too late

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Tuesday urged investors, corporates and venture capital funds to “get into action” and start investing in India before it is “too late”.

He said India’s investment ecosystem is ready, the domestic market is vast, and the government would help investors connect with market opportunities, while a supportive policy framework is already in place.

“To our investors and venture funds, the time is now, get into action and start investing before it is too late. Indian family offices, Indian venture capital funds, Indian investors, Indian corporates, they all have to come into action.

“The ecosystem is ready. Our startups are doing some phenomenal work. There are tried and tested models in India. The market is large. Government will help connect you to the market. The policy framework is available. Get open to ideas on that front and invest in the future that India offers to the world,” he said.

The minister was speaking at the closing ceremony of ‘Bharat Innovates 2026’ in Nice, France.

He also called upon the domestic industry to promote startups by joining hands with them in the manufacturing segment. “So that India will become your (Indian industries) launch pad and the global market will become your destination,” Goyal said, while urging researchers, academia and higher institutes to jointly carry



Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal addresses the ‘Bharat Innovates’ event, in France

Goyal also called upon the domestic industry to promote startups by joining hands with them in the manufacturing segment

out R&D programmes.

He said it will help India reduce the time towards scientific discovery and reduce the time to market the good work that is being done in India.

The government has announced a series of measures to promote the startup ecosystem in India. It has rolled out a startup action plan to support budding entrepreneurs.

The minister said that almost the entire amount of the second tranche of the Rs 10,000 crore Fund of Funds scheme is

going to be committed for deep tech innovators and entities.

He also asked the domestic industry to leverage free trade agreements (FTAs) finalised by India in recent years.

Besides, Goyal sought suggestions on further improving the ease of doing business in the country and on measures to encourage Indian startups working overseas to return and establish their base in India.

“All those who are working around the world, many of whom want to come back... Give us some suggestions. How can we make the path of coming back to India to serve our mother land? How can we encourage so many young men and women researchers and innovators?”

“We’ve been working for others for developing technologies... How can we help bring them back to India? How do we attract them?” he asked.

Services sector led India’s record high exports of \$863.1 bn in FY26

NEW DELHI: India’s services sector emerged as the key driver behind the country’s record combined exports of \$863.1 billion in FY26, according to data released by the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.

The country’s total exports of merchandise and services reached an all-time high of \$863.1 billion in FY26, registering a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 5.7 per cent between FY15 and FY26.

Services exports witnessed robust growth during the period, rising from \$158.1 billion in FY15 to \$421.3 billion in FY26. The segment recorded a CAGR of 9.3 per cent over the 12-year period, significantly outpacing merchandise exports.

As a result, the share of

Services exports rose from \$158.1 bn in FY15 to \$421.3 bn in FY26. The segment posted CAGR of 9.3% over 12-year period

services in India’s total exports increased from 33.8 per cent in FY15 to 48.8 per cent in FY26, underlining the growing importance of the sector in the country’s export basket.

Merchandise exports also maintained a steady growth trajectory, increasing from \$310 billion in FY15 to a record \$441.7 billion in FY26.

The segment registered a CAGR of 3.3 per cent during

the period. India’s non-petroleum exports also touched a record high of \$387.9 billion in FY26, surpassing the previous peak of \$374.1 billion recorded in FY25.

The segment registered a growth of 3.6 per cent over the previous fiscal year.

According to the data, non-petroleum exports stood at \$253.6 billion in FY15, rose to \$266.1 billion in FY18 and remained largely stable at \$266 billion during the pandemic-affected FY21.

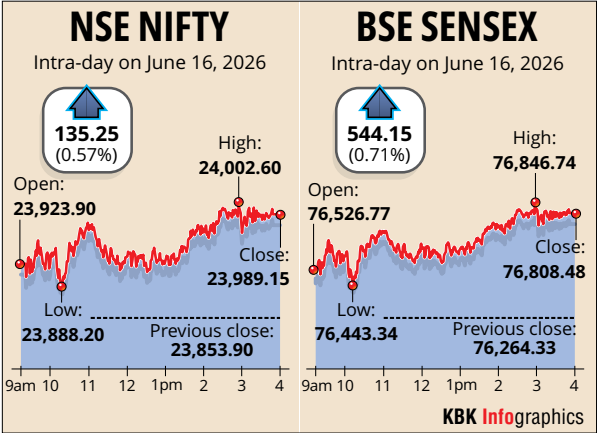
The segment rebounded sharply to \$354.5 billion in FY22 and continued its upward momentum to reach record levels in FY26, reflecting resilience and structural strength in India’s manufacturing and export sectors.

MUMBAI: Benchmark stock indices Sensex and Nifty rose for the third consecutive day on Tuesday, propelled by a positive trend in global markets and softening crude oil prices following a peace deal between the US and Iran.

The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 544.15 points, or 0.71 per cent, to settle at 76,808.48 following gains in IT, select energy and banking stocks. Intraday, it surged 582.41 points, or 0.76 per cent, to 76,846.74.

A total of 2,368 stocks advanced, while 1,886 declined and 153 remained unchanged on the BSE.

The 50-share NSE Nifty climbed 135.25 points, or 0.57 per cent, to end at 23,989.15. During the day, it jumped 148.7 points, or 0.62 per cent, to 24,002.60..



In three straight sessions, Sensex jumped 2,975.93 points, or 4 per cent, and the Nifty climbed 827.55 points, or 3.57 per cent. Foreign investors turning net buyers in Indian equities also boosted the sentiment,

InvITs distribute ₹22,800 cr to unitholders in last fiscal

NEW DELHI: Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs) distributed nearly Rs 22,800 crore to unitholders during the last fiscal, according to industry data.

In a statement on Tuesday, Bharat InvITs Association (BIA) said, “During FY26, InvITs distributed Rs 22,769 crore, taking cumulative distributions since inception to Rs 91,000 crore”

The Assets Under Management (AUM) also grew from Rs 6.3 lakh crore in 2024-25 to Rs 7.1 lakh crore in FY26.

With nearly 2 lakh new unitholders added during the last fiscal year, the total unitholder base of listed InvITs grew by 64 per cent.

“This growth reflects increasing awareness and acceptance of InvITs as a

stable, income-generating investment avenue, particularly among retail investors seeking long-term returns from infrastructure assets,” the association said.

During the last fiscal, InvITs raised Rs 1.97 lakh crore through equity, compared to Rs. 1.75 lakh crore in FY25.

The industry’s gross debt stood at Rs 3.35 lakh crore as of 31 March 2026.

The BIA is the apex industry body for Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs) in India. It acts as a unified platform for InvITs, regulators, institutional investors, UHNIs, and other stakeholders to collaborate on shaping the future of infrastructure financing through capital markets.

Central banks globally pivot to bullion amid rising geopolitical turmoil, says WGC survey

NEW DELHI: A striking shift is underway in the bedrock of global finance. Central banks around the world are aggressively doubling down on gold, with a record number of institutions planning to expand their bullion holdings over the next year.

An overwhelming 89 per cent of respondents believe that global central bank gold reserves will increase over the next 12 months, World Gold Council’s 2026 Central Bank Gold Reserves Survey said.

According to the report, “a record 45 per cent of respondents expect their own gold reserves will also increase” over the coming year. In contrast, only 1 per cent of respondents expect their institution’s gold reserves to decline, while the majority anticipate no change.

The WGC said central banks have accumulated an average of 1,000 tonnes of gold annually over the last four years, significantly higher than the 500-tonne average recorded during the previous decade. The organisation attributed the trend to persistent geopolitical and economic uncertainty affecting reserve managers worldwide.

“Our 2026 Central Bank Gold Reserves (CBGR) survey was conducted between 5 February and 19 May. With the majority of responses coming in after the start of the Middle East conflict, this year’s survey contains insights on how central bankers view gold in the light of ongoing geopolitical turmoil,” the report noted. The survey highlighted that gold’s role during periods of crisis remains one of the strongest factors driving

central bank demand.

The WGC said “gold’s performance during times of crisis, portfolio diversification and inflation hedging” were among the key reasons cited by respondents for holding the metal. In addition, the report pointed to growing recognition of gold as a geopolitical risk hedge and as an important component of reserve diversification policies.

The survey also indicated a gradual shift in the composition of global reserves away from the US dollar. According to the findings, 74 per cent of respondents expect US dollar holdings within global reserves to be moderately or significantly lower over the next five years, while gold’s share is expected to increase. On future purchases, half of the respondents said new gold acquisitions would

be funded through domestic purchase programmes in local currency, while 38 per cent indicated they would finance purchases by selling existing reserve assets.

The report also revealed changes in gold storage strategies among central banks. The Bank of England remained the most preferred vaulting location, used by 57 per cent of respondents, followed by domestic storage at 49 per cent and the Bank for International Settlements at 16 per cent.

The WGC noted that central banks are increasingly diversifying storage arrangements. Around 9 per cent of respondents said they had increased domestic storage over the past year, while 10 per cent reported diversifying overseas storage locations.



showed improvement. Sales growth of Information Technology (IT) companies increased to 9.9 per cent year-on-year from 8.8 per cent in the previous quarter. Non-IT services

companies recorded a sharper rise, with sales growth accelerating to 20.3 per cent, largely supported by the wholesale and retail drug segment.

However, manufacturers faced rising input costs amid global uncertainties. Raw material expenses increased 18.3 per cent year-on-year during the quarter, while the raw material-to-sales ratio climbed to 58.5 per cent from 57.5 per cent in the previous quarter, indicating growing cost pressures.

Staff cost growth for manufacturing companies moderated to 9.8 per cent year-on-year. In the services sector, employee expenses grew at a faster pace for non-IT companies, while remaining broadly stable for IT firms. On a sequential basis, operating profit margins of manufacturing companies remained stable during the quarter, whereas margins for services companies moderated in the final quarter of the fiscal year.

‘Sales of over 1,800 listed mfg cos rise 14.5% in Q4 FY26’

At aggregate level, listed pvt non-financial cos recorded sales growth of 13.9% during 24 FY26

MUMBAI: Sales of more than 1,800 listed private manufacturing companies rose 14.5 per cent year-on-year in the fourth quarter of 2025-26, driven by strong performance in automobiles, electrical machinery and non-ferrous metals, according to data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Tuesday.

At the broader level, listed private non-financial companies maintained double-digit growth, with aggregate sales rising 13.9 per cent during Q4

FY26, up from 10.1 per cent in the preceding quarter. The RBI’s assessment is based on abridged quarterly financial results of 3,266 listed non-government non-financial companies.

According to the central bank, sales growth among 1,817 listed manufacturing firms accelerated from 11.4 per cent in the previous quarter to 14.5 per cent in Q4FY26, led by automobiles, electrical machinery and non-ferrous metals.

The services sector also

MCCI HOSTS FRENCH DELEGATION



Florent Mangin, Chief of Service, Economic Affairs, Embassy of France in India addressing the Session. On his right: Estelle David, Director, South Asia, Business France, New Delhi, Dana Brahmi, Deputy of Economic Affairs, Embassy of France in India and Payal Kanwar, Director General, Indo-French, Chamber of Commerce & Industry (IFCCI). On his left: Arun Kumar Garodia, Chairman, Council on Foreign Trade, MCCI, Thierry Morel, Consul General of France in Kolkata at the Interactive Session with French Business Delegation on Tuesday at MCCI.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM

Ref: (i) Tender Notice No. 16/2026-2027 dated 30.05.2026
(ii) Tender No. 12265005A due on 29.06.2026

1. In reference to above tender, the due date has been extended from 23.06.2026 to 29.06.2026.
2. In reference to above tender, CAMC has been removed from the item description under the goods category.
All other terms & conditions remain unchanged.
The corrigendum has been published on website www.ireps.gov.in.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Chagana Devi @ Rajni W/o Dharam Singh R/o Jhuggi No. D-709, T Huts, K-Block, Jahangirpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 11/2020 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Jahangirpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Chagana Devi @ Rajni** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Chagana Devi @ Rajni** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Chagana Devi @ Rajni** of **FIR No. 11/2020 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Jahangirpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **17.07.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
North District, Court No. 06, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7760/NW/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Arvind Kumar, S/o: Yad Ram Singh R/o: H.No. 23/2 Gali No. 4 Sethi Enclave Vikas Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 639/16, U/s: 498A/406/506/34 IPC, PS: Ranhola, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Arvind Kumar**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Arvind Kumar**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Arvind Kumar**, of **FIR No. 639/16, U/s: 498A/406/506/34 IPC, PS: Ranhola, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Anamika
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Mahila Court-08
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7863/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

UJVN Ltd.
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJWAL" Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763508 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

RO No. 509 **DATE EXTENSION NOTICE-1** Date: 16.06.2026
Due to unavoidable reasons date of submission and opening of bids against E- Tender no.: **CH(Maint.)-11/2026-27** are extended as given here below:-
Last date of downloading tender: 23.06.2026, 16:00 Hrs
Last date of submission of tender: 23.06.2026, 16:00 Hrs
Last date of hard copy submission: 24.06.2026, 12:00 Hrs
Date & Time of opening of tender: 25.06.2026, 11:00 Hrs
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "<http://ukttenders.gov.in>".
Executive Engineer (Maint.) Chibro

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Taranjit Singh Chandok S/o Late Jaspal Singh R/o H. No. 190, Ward No. 4, Purana Bassi Road, Morinda, P/S City Morinda, Distt. Rupnagar, Punjab-140101** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 58/2019 U/s 419/420 IPC & 12PP ACT, PS IGI Airport, New Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Taranjit Singh Chandok** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Taranjit Singh Chandok** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Taranjit Singh Chandok** in **FIR No. 58/2019 U/s 419/420 IPC & 12PP ACT, PS IGI Airport, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.11.2026**.

By order
Sh. Pranav Joshi
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate-01
Patiala House Courts, New Delhi

DP/8028/IGIA/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Multan Khan, S/o: Sultan Khan, R/o: H. No. 40, Khari Kuan Tol Mohalla, District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CT No. 3052/2020 U/s 138 NI Act, P.S.: Jyoti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Multan Khan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Multan Khan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Multan Khan** accused of offence in case **CT No. 3052/2020 U/s 138 NI Act, P.S.: Jyoti Nagar, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Manisha Bhau
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 (NI Act)
Room No. 05, Shahdara, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/7928/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY LTD
(a successor company of cseb)
O/o Executive Director (O&M) Floor, Old administrative building, Danganaya Raipur (C.G.)-492013
PHONE NO: 0771-2574502/2574505/2574909 FAX:0771-2574900/2574922>Email ID: cconm.raipur@cspcd.in
No. 02-01/ED(O&M)/GEN/NT/TR-20/1007 Raipur dtd. 15-06-26

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Sealed tender, for the following work are invited:-

Tender Specification No.	Work	Approximately tender value Rs. In Lacs.	Purchase/download of tender document fee in Rs.	Last date of tender submission
02-01/ED (O&M)/TR-20 Rfx No 8100052267	The work of hiring of 12 No. computer operator for O/o ED (O&M) CSPDCL Raipur	62.25	5000/-	06.07.2026

Important:-(I) Please note that any notice for corrigendum or extension of due date of tender opening shall not be published in newspapers. (II) The tenders will be processed through e-bidding module of SAP-SRM. Bidders are advised to visit our website <http://cspcdcl.co.in> for viewing detailed instructions regarding submission of offer through SAP-SRM.
Executive Director (O&M)

SAVE ELECTRICITY samvad 48168/2 CSPDCL:Raipur

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA
E- mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010

LOOK OUT NOTICE
On 08-06-2026, one person namely Vikas Kumar S/O Satish Kumar R/O Barnoti Tehsil and District Kathua lodged a written report at Police Station Kathua stating therein that on 08-06-2026 at about 0900 hrshis wife namely Monika, age 25 years went missing from home. The complainant tried his best to search for his wife but all in vain.On this, missing report vide DD No. 22 dated 08-06-2026 has been entered at Police Station Kathua.
During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas she is still un-traced.
As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individuals being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

- Name
- Husband
- Permanent Address
- Present Address
- Tehsil
- Police Station
- Age
- Height
- Complexion
- Built
- Face
- Eyes
- Languages known

Monika

Vikas Kumar

Barnoti

Barnoti

Kathua

Kathua

25 years

5 feet 5 inch

Fair

Normal

Round

Black

Hindi/ Dogri



Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following Contacts:-
1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01 922-234311 (Phone/Fax)
4. Police Station Kathua – 01922-234310

Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Kathua.

DIP No:DP/J-3798/26

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
GREATER LUDHIANA AREA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
GLADA Complex, Rajguru Nagar, Ferozepur Road, Ludhiana
Tender Reference No. 601 Dated 16-06-2026
Divisional Engineer (C-I), GLADA, Ludhiana re-invites online bids for the following works:
1. Development of commercial pocket (Reserve pocket for shopping) near Gunwadh Sahib in Sector 32-A, Samrala road, Ludhiana including civil and electrical works.
2. Repair of commercial pocket along 80'-0" wide road in Sector 38, Samrala road, Ludhiana by providing and laying open graded premix surfacing of 20mm thickness in parking area and 50mm thick pavers in pavement area and 80mm thick pavers in road berm along commercial including civil, public health and electrical works.
Closing date & time: **For Sr. no. 1 : 30-06-2026 at 11:00 AM**
For Sr. no. 2 : 03-07-2026 at 11:00 AM
For details log onto: <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
Note: Any corrigendum(s) to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only.
RO No PR-Advt. No :- 1323/12/2026-27/12424

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, **Sh. Subhash Rath, M/s Istuti Services Pvt. Ltd. R/o. 147/5, Sector-22, Rohini, Delhi-110086**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case Reg. No. 17882/2019, U/s: 138 NI ACT**, registered at **P.S.: Aman Vihar, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Sh. Subhash Rath**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Sh. Subhash Rath**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person, **Sh. Subhash Rath**, Case Reg. No. 17882/2019, U/s: 138 NI ACT, registered at **P.S.: Aman Vihar, Delhi**, are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.08.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04,
Room No.112,
Rohini Court Delhi

DP/8040/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Firoz, S/o Aziz, R/o H.No. B-2/44, Kailash Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 1497/2014, U/s 457/380/411/34 IPC, P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Firoz** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Firoz** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Firoz** accused of **FIR No. 1497/2014, U/s 457/380/411/34 IPC, P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.08.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Shagun
JMFC, North West, Court No. 109
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/8037/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Rafiq, S/o: Sh. Samsu Rehman Sheikh, R/o Vagabond, Nigam Bodh Ghat, Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 0057/2021, U/s: 411 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Rafiq**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Rafiq**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Rafiq, FIR No.: 0057/2021, U/s: 411 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.07.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
Central, Court No. 138, First Floor,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/8024/N/2026
(Court Matter)

UJVN LIMITED
H.O. "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Time Extension Notice -I Date: 16/06/2026
Due to unavoidable reasons the schedule date of e- Tender No: 5/EE(Gen)/Khodri/2026-27: Procurement of 5KV Insulation Tester for Khodri Power Station" invited by office of Executive Engineer (Generation), Khodri Power Station, Dakpathar is extended as given below:-
Last date for submission of tender on portal: 22.06.2026 up to 16:00 hrs
Last date of submission of original documents in hard copy : 23.06.2026 up to 16:00 hrs.
Date of opening of tender on portal : 24.06.2026 at 12:30
All other terms & conditions of the tender shall remain unaltered.
Executive Engineer (Generation)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

Annexure 1
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
MINOR IRRIGATION DIVISION, RAMGARH
e-Procurement portal (Two Envelope system)
Tender Reference No. WRD/MID/RAMGARH F2 - 05/2026-27
Date :- 13/06/2026

1.	Name of the work	DMFT न्यास परिषद से अनुमोदन के द्वारा स्वीकृत योजना Construction of PCC Road from Village Labga Chowk Via Patratu Dam to Murkatti Pandey Talab at vill-Labga, G.P. - Labga, Block Patratu, Dist - Ramgarh
2.	Estimated Cost Rs.	Rs. 1,41,89,900.00
3.	Cost of Tender Document (Rs.)	Rs. 10,000.00
4.	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Rs. 2,83,798.00
5.	Time of Completion	120 Days
6.	Mode of Submission of tender	Online through www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
7.	Date of Publication of Tender on website (http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)	20.06.2026 At 02:00 PM
8.	Last Date/Time for downloading of bidding documents and Submission of Tender on Website	27.06.2026 At 05:00 PM
9.	Last Date/Time for Submission of Tender Fee and EMD	27.06.2026 At 05:00 PM
10.	Technical Bid Opening Date	29.06.2026 At 02:00 PM
11.	Officer Inviting Bids	Executive Engineer, Minor Irrigation Division, Ramgarh
12.	Contact number & Email ID of e-procurement officer	06553-231173/829457160 emidramgarh224408@gmail.com
13.	Helpline number of e-procurement cell	0651-2491232

Note :-
(1) Only e-Tenders will be accepted.
(2) Published Estimated Cost may Increase or Decrease.
Further details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>
कार्यपालक अभियन्ता,
लघु सिंचाई प्रमखल, रामगढ़
PR 382499 Minor Irrigation (26-27)_D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **(1) Kuheri Dutta**, (Managing directors of M/S BONZO KIDS Apparel, PVT LTD R/o: S-67, 2nd floor, OIA Ph-II New Delhi also at: H. No. N-16, Ground Floor, C.R Park New Delhi also at: H. No. T-28, 3rd Floor, OIA, New Delhi **(2) Pranav Guha Thakurta** (Managing directors of M/S BONZO KIDS Apparel, PVT LTD R/o: 1. S-67, 2nd floor, OIA Ph-II New Delhi also at: H. No. T-28, 3rd Floor, OIA, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CT Case No. 14823/2019, U/s:138 NI, PS: Chittranjan Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **(1) Kuheri Dutta**, **(2) Pranav Guha Thakurta**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **(1) Kuheri Dutta**, **(2) Pranav Guha Thakurta**, has absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **(1) Kuheri Dutta**, **(2) Pranav Guha Thakurta**, of **CT Case No. 14823/2019, U/s:138 NI, PS: Chittranjan Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.07.2026**.
By Order
Shruti Sharma
Judicial Magistrate First Class NI ACT-02,
Court No. 609, Sour East District
Saket Court New Delhi

DP/7958/SD/2026
(Court Matter)

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Sukhbir
Civil Judge (Junior Division) Bhiwani
CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA
Vs.
M/S ANKU HARDWARE STORE
CS -286-2025
CNR No. . HRBH02-000422-2025
Next Date 16-07-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
DEF NO.1 M/S ANKUR HARDWARE
STORE VILLAGE MUNDHAL KHURD,
TEHSIL AND DISTRICT BHIWANI
THROUGH ITS PROPRIETOR
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **16-07-2026 at 10:00 am**.
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=distriot notice & district = Bhiwani>
Sd/- Sh. Sukhbir
Civil Judge (junior Division)
Dated 11.06.2026 Bhiwani

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
Open Tender Notice No. SRDEE-TRD-IZN-2026-27-T08 Date-15.06.2026
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD, North Eastern Railway, Izzatnagar for and on behalf of President of India, invites sealed "OPEN" E-Tender for the following work. **S. N.:- 1., Name of work:-** OHE related work for conversion of Gaushtala halt into 3 line crossing station in Izzatnagar Division.. **Tender reference no:-** SRDEE-TRD-IZN-2026-27-T08, **Approx. Cost (in Rs.):** 2,03,94,222.51, **Earnest money/Bid Security (in Rs.):** 4,07,900.00, **Cost of tender documents (in Rs):** 00, **E-Tender closing date and Time:-** 08.07.2026 11:00, **Completion period:-** 12 Month, **E-Tender Online will be submitted upto 11:00 Hrs on date:** 08.07.2026 * For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the Official website if Indian railways i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD CPRO/Elect.-72 Izzatnagar
Do Not Smoke Bidi/Cigarette in train

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Munir Khan, S/o Mujib Khan, R/o C-216, Lohiya Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CT No. 2985/2020, P.S. Gazipur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Munir Khan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Munir Khan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Munir Khan** accused of **CT No. 2985/2020, P.S. Gazipur, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.07.2026**.
By Order - **Sh. Sachin**
JMFC-03, East District, Court No. 16,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/7678/ED/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender No.: PU-CNB-W-03-2026 Dated: 02.06.2026
TENDER NOTICE (SINGLE Packet)

Dy. Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/Project, North Central Railway Project Unit, Kanpur for and on behalf of the President of India invites open e-Tender from reputed contractors/JV firms with adequate experience and financial capability, for the following work on Single Packet System up to 13.00 hrs. on the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. If date of opening is declared a holiday or offer could not be opened due to Technical issue, the offers shall be opened on the next working day. The details of the Tender are as under:-
Name of work: Construction of Station Service Building along with associated miscellaneous works at NYN station and Construction of S&T Service Buildings in section & other miscellaneous civil works in the jurisdiction of Dy. CSTE/PU/CNB in Prayagraj Division of North Central Railway
Estimated Cost of Work: Approx. Cost Rs. 44011752.65 only (Four Crore Forty Lakh Eleven thousand Seven Hundred Fifty Two and Paise Sixty Five only).
Earnest Money: Rs.880200.00 (Eight Lakh Eighty thousand & Two hundred only).
Tender form cost: NIL **Completion Period:** 12 months
Availability of tender form: Tender forms shall be available on web site, www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to date of opening of the tender.
Closing Date/Time of Tender: 25.06.2026 before 13:00 Hrs
Tender Opening Date/Time: 25.06.2026 at 13:00 Hrs.
Place of Opening: Through Online E-Portal www.ireps.gov.in in the office of CSTE/PU/INCRPU, HQ Office, Subedarganj, Prayagraj (UP)
Validity of Offer: 45 days from date of opening.
Right of Railway to deal with Tender: Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons.
Tenders who wish to participate in tenders invited on www.ireps.gov.in have to register on the website mandatorily. Please refer to website for more details. Tenders can submit EMD only through online mode. Online payment of earnest money can be made through net banking, debit/credit card etc. Further particulars can be obtained from Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. 1356/26(A)
f North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
No. DYCE-II-GSU-PRYJ-12-2026 Dated: 13.06.2026
E-TENDER NOTICE

Dy. Chief Engineer-II/GSU/Prayagraj, North Central Railway, acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-tenders for the following work through **Open Tender-Two Packet System**. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.
Tender No.: DYCE-II-GSU-PRYJ-12-2026 **Approx.Cost of Work (INR):** ₹ 8.99 Cr.
Brief Description of work: Appointment of General Consultants for the office of Chief Administrative Officer/Construction, Road Safety Projects, North Central Railway.
Amount of EMD (INR): ₹ 5,99,800/- **Completion Period:** 24 Months
Cost of Tender Document: 0.00/-
Tender Opening date and Time: 21.07.2026, 15:00 Hrs.
Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-works tender will be available on website <https://ireps.gov.in> up to 15:00 hrs. on the due date of tender opening. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, venders are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with class III Digital signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 3. Rate entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head attached by tenderer shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. 4. Documents being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. 5. In case of any difficulty, helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 1355/26(DG)
f North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Tender Notice No. 4020262027 Dated: 12.06.2026
E-TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following work up to **13:30 hrs on 08.07.2026**. The details of the Tenders are as under:-
Tender No.: 103, **Name of Work:** Supply and stacking of Welding Portions for 60 kg and R-260 grade rails in section of DENV/PRYJ (for 02 Years).
Approx Cost of work (Rs): 1,95,07,013.82 **Earnest money (Rs):** 3,90,200.00
Completion Period: 24 Months, **Date of Opening of tender:** 8.07.2026, **Similar work for Eligibility Criteria:** Supply of 52 kg/60 kg Alumino Thermic welding portion from RDSO approved firm only.
Note: 1. Tender on line can be submitted up to 13:30 hrs. on 08.07.2026
2. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.ireps.gov.in up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening.1.e 08.07.2026 1344/26 (D)
f North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Notice No.: 2026-June-03 Dated: 13.06.2026
E-TENDERING NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), North Central Railway Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:-

S.No.: 1	Tender No.:	2026-June-03-01	Approx Cost (Rs.):	₹ 9198812.42
Description of work: Miscellaneous P.Way work in SSE/PWIAH section under ADEN/LINE/Agra.				
S.No.: 2	Tender No.:	2026-June-03-02	Approx Cost (Rs.):	₹ 12822038.38
Description of work: Repair to Cess Work at Kms 1290 to 1293 between Mania-Dholpur section (Rajasthan) under jurisdiction of ADEN/DHO.				
S.No.: 3	Tender No.:	2026-June-03-03	Approx Cost (Rs.):	₹ 92882980.45
Description of work: Construction of Type-II and Type-III Quarters under jurisdiction of ADEN/DHO.				

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in". Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" upto 15.00 hrs on 03.07.2026. 1349/26(A)
f North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Sanjay, S/o: Jawala Prasad, R/o. D-5/24, Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.1275/2015 U/S 147/148/149/186/353/120B IPC** registered at **P.S Shahbad Dairy, Outer North District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Sanjay** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Sanjay** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sanjay**, accused of **FIR No.1275/2015 U/S 147/148/149/186/353/120B IPC, P.S Shahbad Dairy, Outer North District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.07.2026**.
By Order, Ms. Bharti Beniwal,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North),
Room No.114, Rohini Courts, Delhi.

DP/8049/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
No. PU-TDL-W-03-2026 Dated: 12.06.2026
Tender Notice

Dy. CSTE/CTC/NCRPU/Tundla, N. C. Railway, for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.
E-Tender Notice No.: PU-TDL-W-03-2026
Description of work: Construction of S&T service buildings (LSC) in KAA-ALJN section in connection with the work of "Reliability improvements of track circuits by provision of MSDAC in parallel of existing DCTC at 14 stations in KAA-ALJN section of Prayagraj Divn. of NCR.
Approx. Cost: 2,50,28,756.15 (Rs. Two Crore Fifty Lakh Twenty Eight Thousand Seven Hundred Fifty Six and Fifteen Paise Only)
Bid Security: 500600/- (Rs. Five Lakh Six Hundred Only)
Cost of Tender form: Nil **Date of closing:** 06.07.2026
Completion period: 09 Months. **Note:-** 1) The complete information along with Tender document of above E-Works Tender will be available on Website on www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 Hrs. on the due date of Tender opening. 2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Class III Digital signature certificate issued by CCA under IT Act 2000. 3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form / letter head if attached by Tenderer shall be straight way ignored & shall not be considered. 4) Documents being attached should be signed by the Tenderer on its body. 5) For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. 1345/26 FA
f North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See

‘WAS SICK OF PLAYING BOY-NEXT-DOOR ROLES’

Vikrant Massey to star in the Avinash Arun-directed series ‘Pritam and Pedro’

Vikrant Massey said he was tired of essaying the boy next door roles and is happy that he is finally getting to step into the shoes of a different character in the Avinash Arun-directed series ‘Pritam and Pedro’.



Arshad Warsi, Vir Hirani and Mona Singh star alongside Massey in the series, which has filmmaker Rajkumar Hirani attached as creator and producer.

has given me a chance. In the Hirani-verse, antagonists are not conventional. It's the same with Martin," the '12th Fail' star told reporters at the trailer launch of the show.

Created and produced by Hirani, 'Pritam and Pedro' revolves around completely mismatched men who get pulled into a strange cyber-crime mystery filled with humour, confusion and unexpected twists.

The 39-year-old actor said the series revolves around 'a relevant topic'. The actor said he has been a victim of

cybercrime as his emails were hacked twice and his wife also faced an issue when money was deducted from her account.

"It's such a relevant topic, I think everyone has become a victim of it. It's entertaining and you will also see the human side of Martin," said the actor, known for his roles in 'Haseen Dilruba', 'Aankhon Ki Gustakhiyaan' and 'Ginni Weds Sunny'.

The series is set to stream on 'JioHotstar' on July 3.

‘Finally, Hirani sir has given me a chance. In the Hirani-verse, antagonists are not conventional,’ says Massey

“Like everyone says, ‘Even if we get one passing shot or scene in Hirani-verse, then it’s more than enough.’ I am very excited for the

show. Also, the good man turns bad or anti-hero... I was sick of playing village boy or the next-door boy. Finally, Hirani sir



ACROSS CONTINENTS, ONE PULSE

‘The World Is One’ celebrates art, healing & cultural dialogue

OUR CORRESPONDENT

A packed audience at Loddon Hall, Twyford (RG10 9JA), witnessed ‘The World is One’ on June 7, 2026, a compelling celebration of artistic collaboration that brought together Indian and Spanish traditions through dance and music while placing mental wellbeing, environmental consciousness and human connection at its heart.

Presented by Sangeet Foundation and curated by ‘SohiniMoksha World Dance and Communications’, the evening commenced with a welcome address by Nupur Ray, co-founder of the Sangeet Foundation, setting the tone for a programme rooted in inclusion, healing and cultural dialogue.

The programme opened with a moving vocal rendition by Ryka Chakraborty, a talented young singer on the autism spectrum. Her heartfelt performance reflected the foundation's ongoing commitment to mental health awareness and the use of the performing arts as a powerful



One of the highlights of the programme was the dynamic collaboration between Sohini Roychowdhury and Irene Hernández Díaz

medium for emotional wellbeing and healing.

A thought-provoking talk by Aditya Dasbiswas, followed by the evocative ‘Shiva Stotram’ dance presentation, created a profound confluence

of philosophy and embodied expression, where sound, rhythm and devotion merged into a meditative experience of stillness and inner awareness.

In a separate reflective segment, Divya Jayakar and Inder Poonaji spoke about the impact of the environment, drawing attention to ecological balance and humanity's shared responsibility in shaping a more sustainable future, broadening the evening's dialogue beyond artistic expression to collective global consciousness.

One of the highlights of the

programme was the dynamic collaboration between Bharatanatyam exponent Sohini Roychowdhury and Flamenco artist Irene Hernández Díaz, whose performances created a compelling dialogue between two rich artistic traditions. A particularly memorable segment paired the exuberance of Flamenco Alegria with the timeless poetry and music of Rabindranath Tagore, creating a seamless bridge between India and Spain through movement and emotion.

The musical journey continued with a meditative sitar recital by Jonathan Mayer, accompanied by Denis Kucherov on tabla, before culminating in a collaborative finale that united the artistes in a shared tapestry of rhythm, storytelling and improvisation.

Marking the India-Spain Year of Culture 2026, ‘The World is One’ left the packed audience deeply moved, offering a powerful reminder that art can transcend borders, nurture empathy, inspire dialogue and become a catalyst for healing and human connection.

Actor Kunal Kemmu to host reality series ‘Alliance’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Prime Video announced June 26 as the world-wide premiere date of its highly anticipated reality series ‘Alliance’. The show delivers fresh episodes daily, making it the OTT streamer's first-ever daily series globally.

Marking Kunal Kemmu's debut as a reality show host, ‘Alliance’ is the first international adaptation of Talpa Studios' globally acclaimed Dutch format, created by John de Mol, with the adaptation produced by ‘Banijay Asia’.

Known for his impeccable

Spanning 42 episodes across six weeks, the ‘Prime Video’ show will premiere on June 26

comic timing, quick wit and the rare ability to switch effortlessly between comedy, thrillers and intense drama, Kunal Kemmu steps into a never-seen-before avatar, taking on the role of host for the very first time with ‘Alliance’. This game format show, reimagined to meet Indian audiences' entertainment preferences,

brings together 16 contestants who enter the game as duos, but quickly discover that no alliance is permanent. In a game where every alliance can be an advantage, or turn into a roadblock, only one contestant will survive to be the ultimate winner!

“We are thrilled to bring ‘Alliance’, to audiences across the country. As a first-of-its-kind format for India, ‘Alliance’ will combine strategy, shifting loyalties and constantly evolving gameplay,” said Nikhil Madhok, director and head of ‘Originals’, Prime Video, India.



Sunny Deol celebrates 25 years of ‘Gadar’

Directed by Anil Sharma, the film, released in 2001, also starred Ameesha Patel

Thank you all for giving all of us years of abundant love and making us stay in your hearts,” said Sunny Deol as his hit film ‘Gadar’ marked 25 years.

The film, directed by Anil Sharma, was released on June 15, 2001 and also starred Ameesha Patel. It followed a Sikh truck driver, Tara Singh, who saves and marries a Muslim woman, Sakina, only to fight political and geographical odds to reunite with his family.

‘Gadar’ went on to earn over Rs 133 crore at the global box office, turning into the highest grosser in India during the release.

Deol shared a series of pictures from the film on his ‘Instagram’ handle on Monday as he expressed his gratitude to the audience.

“25 years ago, ‘Gadar’ and Tara Singh conquered your hearts. 25 saal se pyaar ke rishte ki gaddi chali rahi aur aage bhi chalti hi rahegi,” he wrote in the caption.

He added, “Thank you all for giving all of us 25 years of abundant love and for making us stay in your hearts. Hope we keep staying there.”

The sequel to the film was released in 2023 and had Deol and Patel reprise



‘Thank you all for giving all of us 25 years of abundant love and for making us stay in your hearts,’ he says

their roles. The film was also praised and went on to earn over Rs 600 crore at the global box office.

‘Portraying J R D Tata came with a huge sense of responsibility’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Veteran actor Naseeruddin Shah's portrayal of J R D Tata in Amazon MX Player's ‘Made in India: A Titan Story’ has emerged as one of the most celebrated performances from the series. Bringing remarkable restraint, depth and quiet authority to the role, the actor's interpretation of the visionary industrialist has struck a chord with viewers, adding emotional weight and authenticity to the story.

Reflecting on the experience, Shah opened up about stepping into the shoes of one of India's most revered business leaders and the creative collaboration that made the journey memorable.

Speaking about essaying the character of J R D Tata, the actor shared, “J R D Tata was singular in a way that is difficult to articulate. What fascinated me most was not his stature but his restraint; he carried his greatness quietly, almost as a matter of habit. I have played many characters over the years, but portraying J R D came



with a huge sense of responsibility because of the legacy he represents. I am delighted that ‘Made in India: A Titan Story’ gave me the opportunity to explore him.”

Reflecting on working with Jim Sarbh, he added, “Jim has something that cannot be manufactured - he listens. Genuinely, completely. On camera, that is rarer than it sounds. His theatre foundation has given him a rigour and intellectual seriousness that translates beautifully on screen and in a series as layered as ‘Made in India: A Titan Story’ and that depth matters enormously. Working with him is, without hesitation, always a genuine pleasure.”

Saif Ali Khan calls ‘Agent Vinod’ a ‘vanity’ project

The film struggled due to a plot that went in too many directions at once

Released more than a decade ago amid considerable hype, Sriram Raghavan's spy actioner ‘Agent Vinod’ ultimately failed to live up to expectations. Despite featuring some of the film industry's most accomplished action choreography and a generous dose of humour woven into its narrative, the film struggled due to a plot that seemed to head in too many directions at once. The box office disappointment was particularly difficult for Saif Ali Khan, who had been deeply invested in the project, both as its lead star and producer.

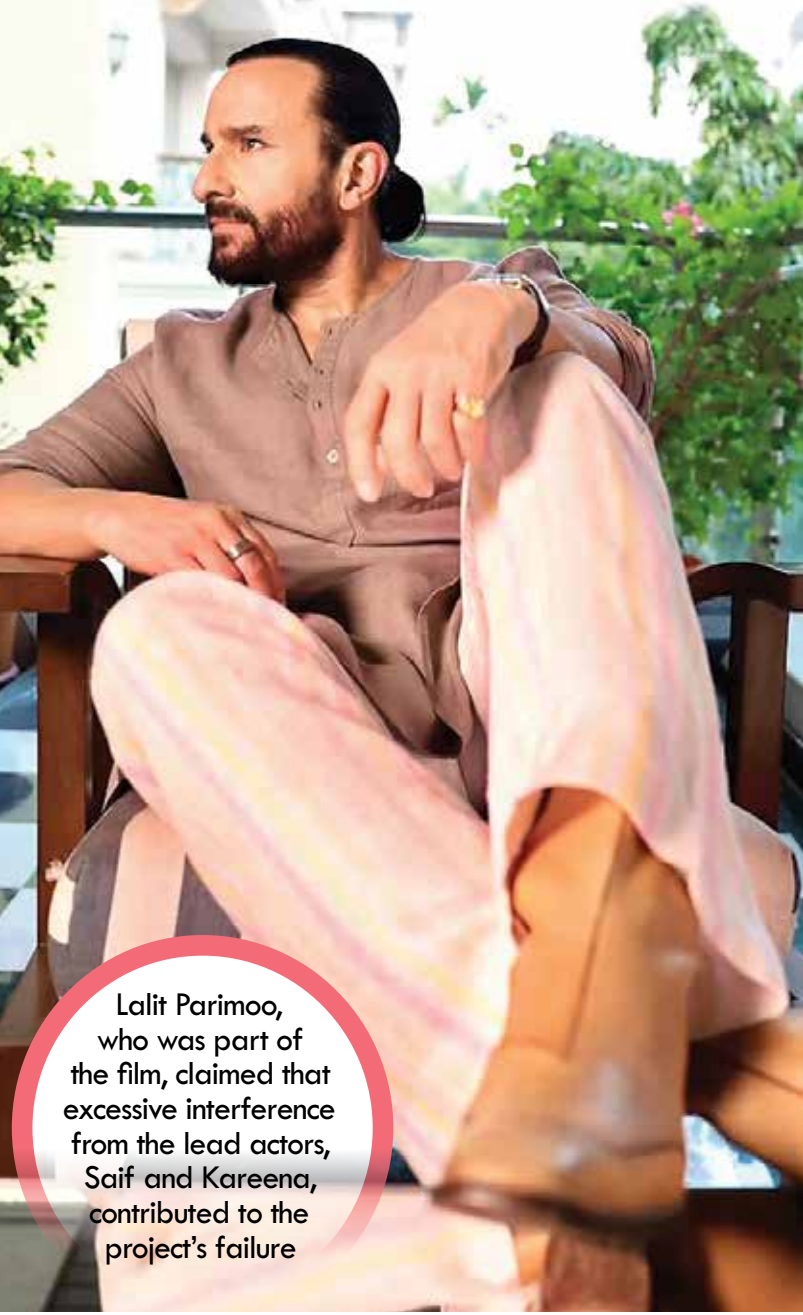
In a conversation with ‘Variety India’, Saif reflected on the film's failure, admitting that ‘Agent Vinod’ may have been driven partly by vanity. “I think of ‘Agent Vinod’ as a film that might have been vain. But also, that film opened really well, you know. It's just that it did not sustain because it probably wasn't a tightly made film, or it went off track in many ways. Or as Sriram himself said, he put too many toppings on the pizza.”

Saif, however, maintained that the film's core idea was strong. “But the idea wasn't bad, the title wasn't bad and it was the right film to make. Imagine a kind of spy movie ahead of its time, perhaps. It was a cool film, but it should have held more. Maybe we made some mistakes.”

He clarified that vanity alone was not responsible for the film's downfall. “But my point is: it was vanity. I was excited to do that. I made the film for myself, but it did open well. So, its failure was not because it was a vain idea.”

His comments come just days after actor Lalit Parimoo, who was part of the film, claimed that excessive interference from the lead actors, Saif Ali Khan and Kareena Kapoor Khan, contributed to the project's failure.

Speaking to Siddharth Kannan, Parimoo said, “I think the main reason was that there was too much interference from the stars, Saif and Kareena. The way Sriram wanted to make that film, he couldn't make it that way. He was constantly being told what he should do, so it became a mess.”



Lalit Parimoo, who was part of the film, claimed that excessive interference from the lead actors, Saif and Kareena, contributed to the project's failure

